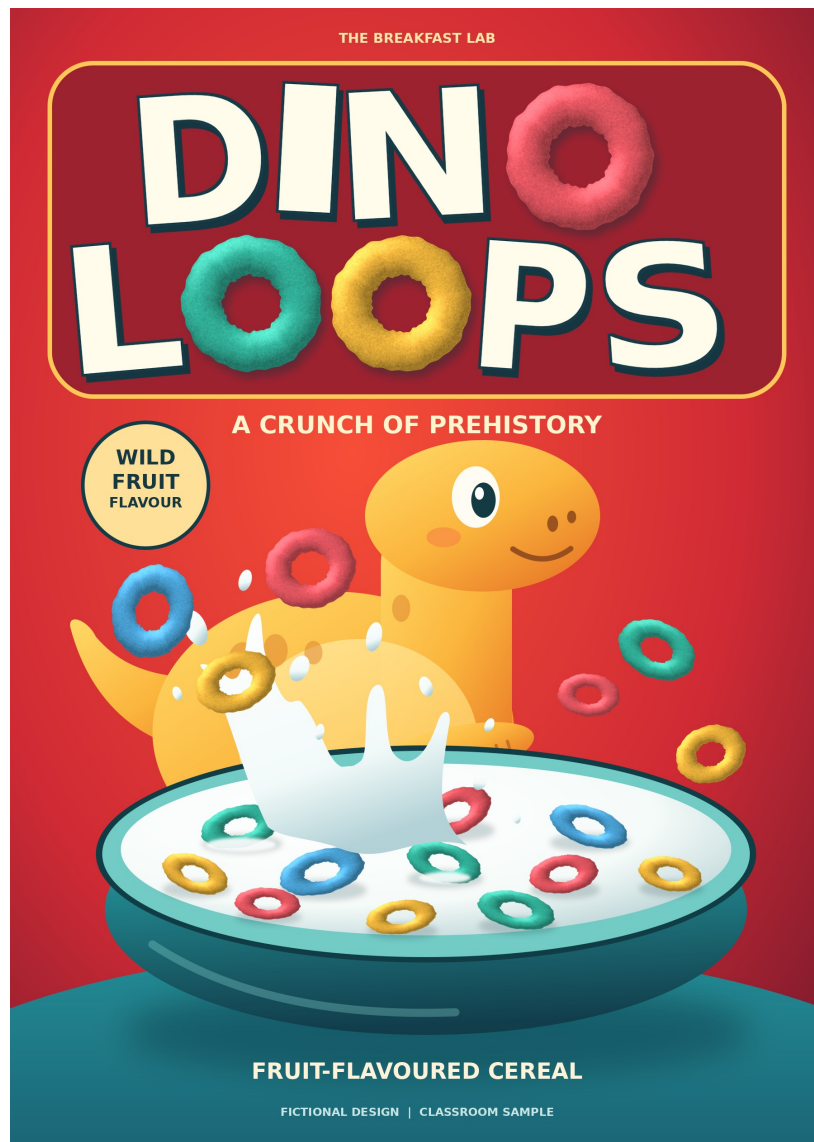


DINO LOOPS

Make the product part of the brand.



Complete illustrated student guide

36 core steps + 4 optional box-mockup steps. Build a bowl, splash, textured cereal system, original mascot and readable wordmark using editable Photoshop layers.

Every step: **Select first** → **numbered actions** → **Why / Check / Fix**.

Companion HTML includes starter downloads, progress checks and exportable process notes.

The project and the adaptation

A new classroom construction—not a copy of a retired 3D workflow.

The Tuts+ lesson uses CS4 Extended's 3D donut workflow, textured cereal, a photographed milk splash and a character-based cereal cover. This adaptation preserves the main visual idea: energetic food imagery, a mascot and cereal replacing letters. It changes the construction: editable 2D shapes, bevelled Smart Object rings, a drawn splash and an original dinosaur. The optional three-panel box presentation is a new extension. It is not a translation of the original numbered steps or a claim to reproduce its photographic result.

This is a Photoshop desktop lesson, not a Photoshop web/mobile lesson. No legacy 3D Donut command, generative-image credit, paid stock asset or additional 3D application is required. Do not use Adobe's older Substance 3D Viewer beta integration as a prerequisite: Adobe's page says Viewer is no longer supported or available for installation as of October 16, 2025. See S1 and S11. Tool names are checked against the linked Adobe documentation; exact layouts can vary by installed version.

What you should learn

By the end, you should be able to construct a transparent textured object, distinguish shared and independent Smart Objects, use masks and overlap to establish depth, build a consistent lighting scheme, and defend a typographic hierarchy with evidence from a revision.

Route	What students build	How to assess it
Full build	Shapes, ring source, mascot, type, masks, composition.	Use all four suggested criteria.
Supported	Composition, typography and masks using approved prepared assets.	Assess demonstrated skills; record supplied construction.

Core output: a flat 1800 × 2520 px front. Optional output: a 2200 × 2200 px box presentation. Neither is a production dieline or a legally complete food package.

Source basis: S1. Version-aware workaround: S11. Documentation is listed at the end. All checkpoint images are newly made teaching composites, not software screenshots.

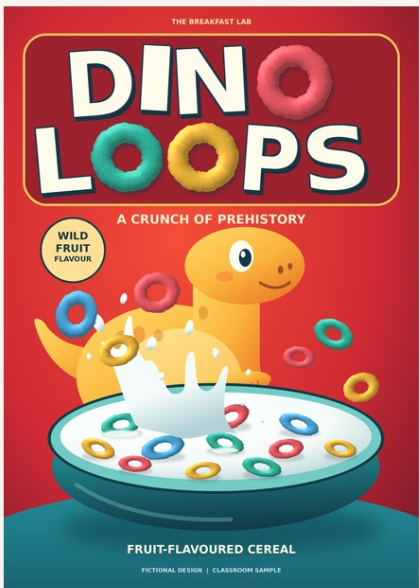
Your route through the project

Use the phase letters in the page headers to find your place.

Phase	Steps	Focus
A	1-4	Plan and prepare
B	5-9	Build the bowl and milk
C	10-16	Make the cereal master
D	17-21	Arrange and integrate
E	22-25	Draw the mascot
F	26-30	Design the brand
G	31-36	Refine and submit
H	37-40	Optional box mockup

A flat cover becomes a perspective presentation

OPTIONAL EXTENSION | Three distorted 2D panels, not a 3D model or a print dieline.



Illustrated checkpoint—not a Photoshop screenshot. Compare structure, not identical filter pixels.

Suggested planning estimate: 6-8 classes of about 70 minutes, plus an optional presentation class. The editable cereal-master checkpoint is the best point to adjust pacing.

Control desk 1 / 2

Shared routines used throughout the numbered steps.

Shape recipe — draw once, then type the values

Select the named group first. Choose a shape tool under U; set mode to Shape, Path Operations to New Layer, and Stroke to None unless instructed otherwise. Draw a rough shape or click once to enter dimensions. In Window > Properties, enter W/H and X/Y; use the upper-left reference point for x/y box coordinates. Colours beginning with # are hexadecimal values entered in the Color Picker. Keep each component on its own named shape layer.

Gradient recipe — control the stops and the visible direction

Select the shape and its shape tool, then open Fill in the options bar and choose Gradient. Click the gradient preview/editor. Lower markers control colours; upper markers control opacity. Double-click a lower marker to enter its colour; select a marker and enter its Location percentage. Click below the strip to add a missing colour stop. Keep all opacity stops at 100%. Choose Linear for a directional gradient or Radial for centre-to-edge shading. Set a vertical gradient to about 90°, then use Reverse or change the angle until the required bright/dark direction is visible. Use this visual test because gradient interfaces and defaults differ between versions.

Transform recipe — distinguish box positions from centres

Ctrl/Cmd+T opens Free Transform. Use the nine-point reference control: upper-left for an x/y box, centre for a cereal centre or rotation point. Enable Show Reference Point in the options bar if the control is hidden. Enter px after a pixel measurement so you do not accidentally enter a percentage. Use the W/H link for proportional scaling; turn it off only when this guide deliberately squashes an ellipse. Shift toggles the current proportional behaviour; do not assume the old rule always applies. Press Enter/Return to commit, Esc to cancel.

Tool references: S2-S4, S7, S10 and S12. Exact values in this lesson are proposed starting settings; use the visual checkpoints to judge the result.

Control desk 2 / 2

Shared routines used throughout the numbered steps.

Mask recipe — choose the correct thumbnail

Select the layer. A normal click on Add Layer Mask makes a white reveal-all raster mask when there is no selection. Alt/Option-click makes a black hide-all raster mask. Click the mask thumbnail before brushing: white reveals, black conceals, grey partly reveals. Press X to swap foreground/background; click the colour swatches when uncertain. A vector shape may already have a vector mask; the new black raster mask is the one used for painted milk overlap.

Smart Object recipe — source versus instance

The thumbnail opens editable contents; the blank area opens Layer Style. Save and close a contents tab to update its parent. Ctrl/Cmd+J creates another instance of the same source; New Smart Object Via Copy creates independent source contents. Use independent objects for four flavours, then linked duplicates for repeated cereal of one flavour. An object's outer transform/effect can differ while its embedded source remains shared.

How to use the coordinates

Shape boxes use x, y, width, height measured from the top-left of the canvas. Ring and droplet tables use centre x/y. Positive angles in these tables turn clockwise. Ring sizes refer to the visible coloured cereal before rotation, not an arbitrary transparent file border. The figures are teaching composites built to the stated layout; your font and Photoshop effects may differ slightly. Judge the checkpoint's structure, not pixel-identical output.

Tool references: S2–S4, S7, S10 and S12. Exact values in this lesson are proposed starting settings; use the visual checkpoints to judge the result.

Starter files 1 / 2

Files are in starter_assets. The self-contained HTML also has individual download buttons.



Illustrated checkpoint—not a Photoshop screenshot. Compare structure, not identical filter pixels.

layout_trace_1800x2520.png

Full-size transparent placement/shape guide. Place at 1800 × 2520 px; hide before exporting.

grain_tile.png

Optional original greyscale texture for a second clipped grain layer.

loop_coral_support.png

Prepared coral ring with a real transparent hole. Shortcut, not a layered student master.

loop_gold_support.png

Prepared gold ring. Use only when the teacher approves the support route.

loop_teal_support.png

Prepared teal ring. Same role and scale family as the other flavours.

loop_blue_support.png

Prepared blue ring. Same role and scale family as the other flavours.

dinosaur_shapes.svg

Original vector character reference. Photoshop may place it as one Smart Object, not separate shape layers.

Starter files 2 / 2

Files are in starter_assets. The self-contained HTML also has individual download buttons.

dinosaur_support.png

Isolated original dinosaur, cropped to its visible bounds. An approved shortcut, not a replacement for construction evidence.

splash_support.png

Isolated illustrated splash. Match the layout guide if using the supported route.

bowl_support.png

Isolated bowl illustration for a supported composite. It lacks the separate milk surface needed for Step 20; reconstruct a matching milk ellipse first.

mockup_trace_2200x2200.png

Exact-size corner guide for the optional box presentation; hide before export.

side_panel_support.png

Optional side-panel placeholder, explicitly marked as a non-sale concept.

top_panel_support.png

Optional top-panel placeholder for the box presentation.

Supported-route placement

The PNG objects are cropped to their visible bounds. Use the full-size trace to match their position and scale. Place the dinosaur support behind the bowl; place the splash in MILK FRONT. A single bowl-support image cannot provide the separate Milk surface needed for the overlap mask—make a matching ellipse before Step 20.

Finished references: assets/final_front.png and assets/box_mockup.png. Reference images are for comparison, not student submission. Teacher-editable lesson text and structured JSON are in editable_source.

01

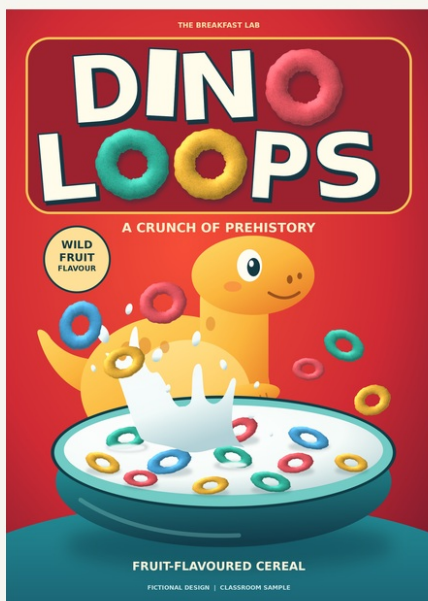
Read the design before building it

SELECT FIRST The finished front reference and your process notes.

1. Create a project folder named **Surname_DinoLoops**. Inside it, make **Working**, **Exports** and **Evidence** folders. Extract the classroom ZIP; keep the supplied assets together.
2. Look at the reference for five seconds, then look away. Write the first three things you noticed. The intended order is the name, the mascot/product scene, then the smaller information.
3. Sketch three zones: a large wordmark at the top, a mascot in the middle, and a bowl across the bottom. Draw an arrow from the upper left to establish the light direction.
4. Choose the **build route** to make the shapes and cereal yourself. Use prepared support PNGs only with teacher approval; record exactly which ones you use.
5. Use the illustrated DINO LOOPS version for your first pass. After it works, propose one intentional change to the palette, character or flavour story. Keep a readable product name.

A flat cover becomes a perspective presentation

OPTIONAL EXTENSION | Three distorted 2D panels, not a 3D model or a print dieline.



Illustrated checkpoint—not a Photoshop screenshot.

WHY

Planning turns the project into an advertisement with priorities, rather than a collection of effects.

CHECK

Your sketch reserves enough room for both words and shows one light direction. Your notes name the route you will take.

FIX

The target is an illustrated depth effect, not a photorealistic render. Do not search for the old 3D Donut command or a missing stock photograph.

Tool reference: S1, S11. Recipe values are lesson starting points.

02

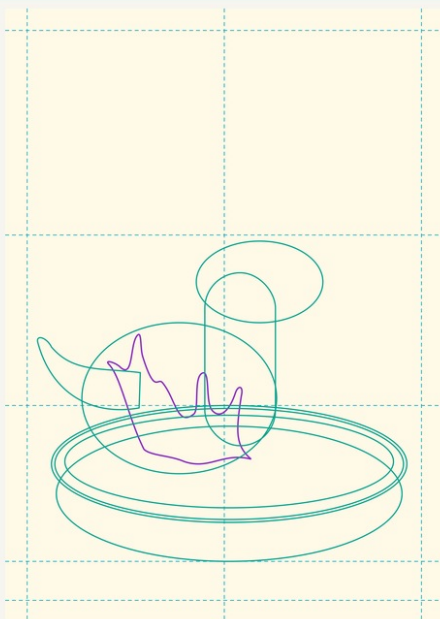
Create the front-panel document

SELECT FIRST Photoshop desktop; no document is required yet.

1. Choose **File > New**. Set Width **1800 Pixels**, Height **2520 Pixels**, Resolution **300 Pixels/Inch**, Color Mode **RGB Color, 8 bit**, and Background Contents **White**. Turn Artboards off.
2. Expand Advanced Options and choose **sRGB IEC61966-2.1** where available. Set Pixel Aspect Ratio to Square Pixels. Click Create.
3. Choose **File > Save As**, save on your computer as **Working/Surname_DinoLoops_FRONT_v01.psd**, and keep layers. Enable Maximize Compatibility if asked.
4. Open **Window > Layers**, **Window > Properties** and **Window > Character**. Choose the Move tool (V); turn Auto-Select off so clicking the canvas will not unexpectedly change layers.
5. Read the Control desk before continuing. Its shape, gradient and coordinate conventions are used throughout this guide.

Layout map: numbers describe positions, not a grading target

DIAGRAM | Coordinates start at the upper-left corner of the 1800 x 2520 canvas.



- 1 Safe guides: x = 90 and 1710.
- 2 Wordmark zone: y = 120 to 860.
- 3 Mascot zone: y = 955 to 1910.
- 4 Bowl rim: x 190, y 1630; 1460 x 480.
- 5 Footer stays above y = 2430.

Illustrated checkpoint—not a Photoshop screenshot.

WHY

The portrait proportions leave room for the name and food scene. RGB is our working space; a pixel count and 300 ppi alone do not make a commercial package.

CHECK

Image > Image Size shows 1800 x 2520 px. The document tab ends in .psd. Your Layers panel is visible.

FIX

An 1800-inch canvas is a unit error. Recreate it in pixels. This flat classroom panel is not a cut-and-fold dieline or a press-ready file.

Tool reference: S4. Recipe values are lesson starting points.

03

Organize the layers and tracing guide

SELECT FIRST Your new front PSD; select the top layer.

1. Click the folder icon at the bottom of Layers to make **00 BACKGROUND**. Make **01 MASCOT**, **02 BOWL**, **03 IN-BOWL CEREAL**, **04 MILK FRONT**, **05 FLYING CEREAL**, **06 WORDMARK** and **07 COPY**. Arrange 07 at the top and 00 at the bottom.
2. Add a **90 LOOP MASTERS** group for protected working copies. Keep it hidden after the four colours are ready. Lock the original white Background layer at the bottom.
3. Choose **File > Place Embedded** and select **layout_trace_1800x2520.png**. Confirm the placement, name the layer **99 TRACE GUIDE**, and drag it above all groups.
4. Use Free Transform with the top-left reference point. Set the guide to **W 1800 px, H 2520 px, X 0 px, Y 0 px**. Press Enter/Return. Lower opacity to 25%, then lock the layer.
5. Turn the guide eye on only while placing or tracing. Turn it off for every checkpoint and final export. Save the PSD.

The layer stack is your depth map

SCHEMATIC | Top rows render in front. The guide sits at the top only while tracing.

07 COPY + LABELS

06 WORDMARK: letters / cereal O / backing

05 FLYING CEREAL

04 MILK FRONT: droplets / splash / overlap

03 IN-BOWL CEREAL + contact shadows

02 BOWL: milk / rim / body / ground shadow

01 MASCOT: face / arm / head / neck / body / tail

00 BACKGROUND: tabletop / radial background

90 LOOP MASTERS (hidden)

99 TRACE GUIDE (hidden, at top while tracing)

Illustrated checkpoint—not a Photoshop screenshot.

WHY

Named groups act as a depth map. The guide provides support without becoming part of the finished artwork.

CHECK

The guide exactly covers the canvas, and the layer stack matches the diagram. Turning off its eye removes every guide line.

FIX

Placed files can arrive scaled. Type dimensions with the px suffix; 100% is not proof of the correct size. Unlock before transforming, then relock.

Tool reference: S4, S12. Recipe values are lesson starting points.

04

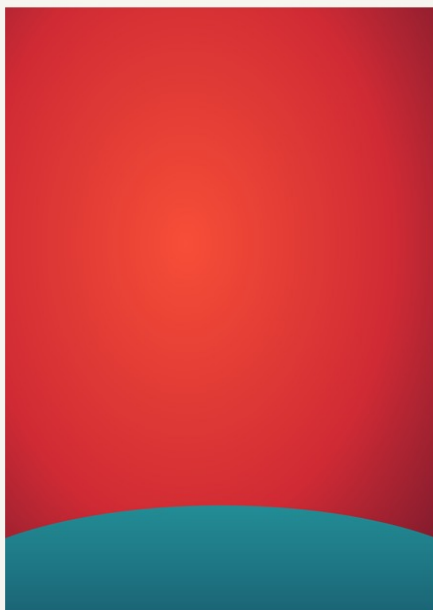
Build the background and tabletop

SELECT FIRST Open 00 BACKGROUND; select an empty area inside the group.

1. Choose **Layer > New Fill Layer > Gradient**. Name it **BG radial**, click OK, then click the gradient preview to edit it. Use colour stops **#F64E37 at 0%**, **#D02B35 at 58%** and **#70182C at 100%**. Keep every opacity stop at 100%.
2. Set Style **Radial**, Scale **130%**, and turn Dither on if offered. While the dialog is open, drag on the canvas to place the bright centre around **x760, y980**. Reverse only if the centre is dark. Click OK.
3. Choose the Ellipse tool (under U), set mode **Shape**, and Stroke to None. Create **Tabletop** at **x -360, y2075, w2520, h910**. The shape deliberately extends beyond the canvas.
4. Give Tabletop a vertical gradient from **#238D96** at the top to **#123C55** at the bottom using the Control desk gradient routine. Keep it above BG radial.
5. Turn the trace off and save. The lower arc is a table surface, not the bowl.

The composition starts with empty space

ILLUSTRATED CHECKPOINT | Compare structure, not identical filter pixels.



PSD geometry: 1800 x 2520 px | Stage 04

- 1 Keep the upper third free for the name.
- 2 Warm background and cool tabletop are separate editable layers.
- 3 Light enters from the upper left.

Illustrated checkpoint—not a Photoshop screenshot.

WHY

The warm/cool contrast separates food and packaging. A bright centre directs attention while darker edges contain the scene.

CHECK

A curved teal area occupies the bottom; most of the canvas remains red. Neither layer is flattened.

FIX

Gradient direction varies with Reverse and angle. Judge the visible result: bright centre, darker outside; lighter table top, darker bottom.

Tool reference: S2, S10. Recipe values are lesson starting points.

05

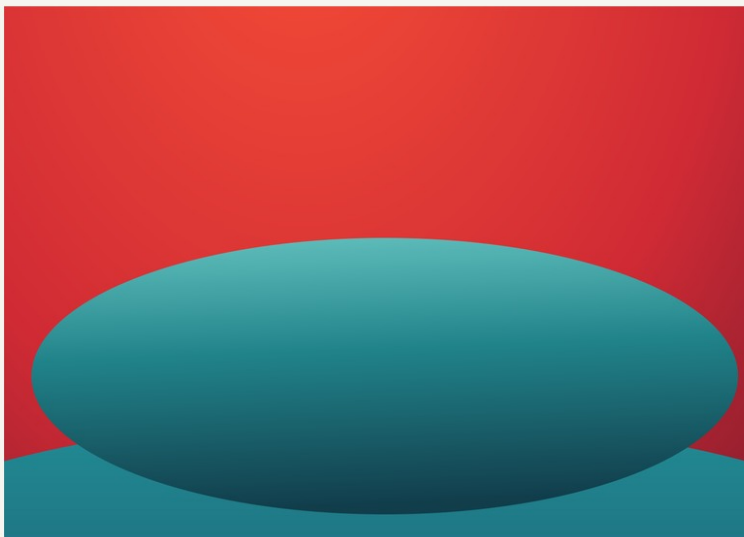
Give the bowl a body

SELECT FIRST 02 BOWL, above the mascot and background groups.

1. Select the Ellipse tool (U). In the options bar choose **Shape**, **New Layer** under Path Operations, and no stroke. Click once to enter **1420 x 555 px**, or draw roughly and enter those dimensions in Properties.
2. Set the upper-left position to **x210, y1715**. Name this shape **Bowl body**. Keep it inside 02 BOWL.
3. Open the shape Fill gradient. Use a vertical gradient with **#64C2BF at 0%**, **#21838A at 45%** and **#123E4C at 100%**. Flip the gradient direction if needed so the bottom is darkest.
4. Leave the ellipse complete. Later rim and milk layers will cover its top half; do not erase that area.
5. Toggle the layer off and on. This is the first of several separate shapes that will create the bowl.

One ellipse begins the bowl

ILLUSTRATED CHECKPOINT | Compare structure, not identical filter pixels.



PSD geometry: 1800 x 2520 px | Stage 05

- 1 The body reaches lower than the rim will.
- 2 A light-to-dark gradient makes a flat shape feel rounded.
- 3 Do not rasterize the shape to add a style.

Illustrated checkpoint—not a Photoshop screenshot.

WHY

The dark lower edge makes a flat ellipse feel rounded. Overlapping whole shapes is easier to revise than cutting away hidden areas.

CHECK

A broad teal ellipse is low on the page. Its top is brighter than its bottom, and its shape thumbnail remains editable.

FIX

If drawing subtracts from an earlier shape, reset Path Operations to New Layer. If there is a coloured outline, set Stroke to None.

Tool reference: S2, S10. Recipe values are lesson starting points.

06

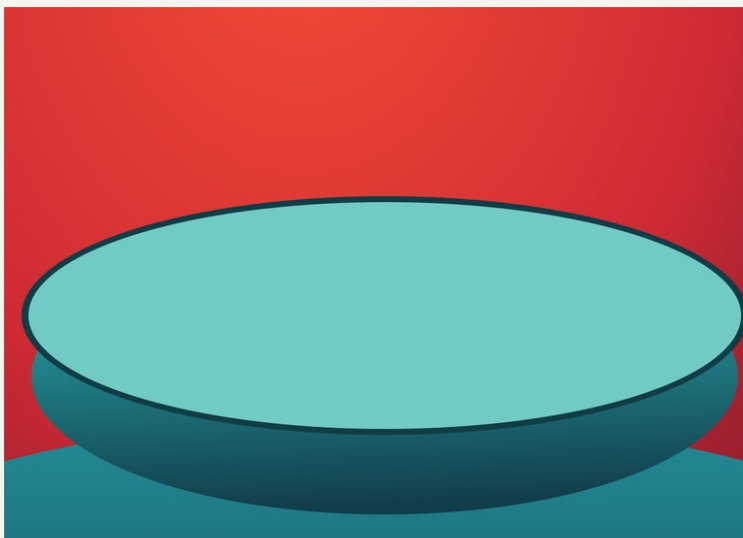
Build a rim from nested ellipses

SELECT FIRST 02 BOWL; click Bowl body before creating the next shapes.

1. Create an ellipse above the body named **Rim outer**. Set **x190, y1630, w1460, h480**. Fill it **#113D47**, with no stroke.
2. Create another ellipse above it named **Rim inner**. Set **x204, y1642, w1432, h456**. Fill it **#72CBC5**, with no stroke.
3. Check that the two ellipse centres align at approximately **x920, y1870**. The dark outer shape should make a thin continuous boundary, not a thick uneven crescent.
4. Keep the order **Rim inner / Rim outer / Bowl body**, from top to bottom. Turn the guide off and compare the checkpoint.
5. Save. Do not merge the three shapes: their independent dimensions control the bowl's apparent depth.

Build the rim as nested ellipses

ILLUSTRATED CHECKPOINT | Compare structure, not identical filter pixels.



PSD geometry: 1800 x 2520 px | Stage 06

- 1 Large dark ellipse: outer silhouette.
- 2 Slightly smaller pale ellipse: ceramic rim.
- 3 The milk goes inside both shapes next.

Illustrated checkpoint—not a Photoshop screenshot.

WHY

The darker boundary and lighter inner rim describe the thickness of the bowl material.

CHECK

The rim extends a little farther left and right than the body. The dark contour is visible around its entire edge.

FIX

An off-centre inner ellipse makes one side much thicker. Re-enter x/y and width/height before trying to fix it by eye.

Tool reference: S10. Recipe values are lesson starting points.

07

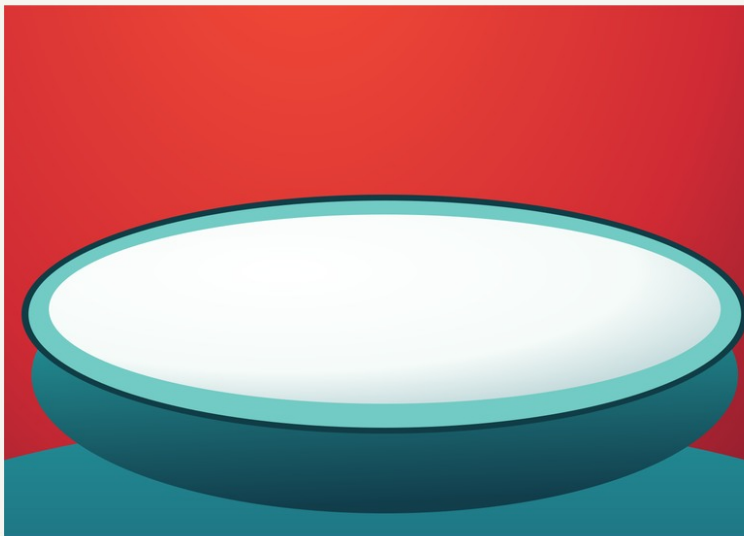
Add milk with a soft depth cue

SELECT FIRST 02 BOWL; select Rim inner.

1. Create an ellipse above the rim named **Milk surface**. Set **x245, y1670, w1350, h380**, and Stroke None.
2. Use the Fill gradient controls to choose a **Radial** gradient: **#FFFFFF at 0%, #F5FBF9 at 62%, and #B1CDD0 at 100%**. Keep the centre nearly white and the edge cool and slightly darker.
3. Leave Milk surface separate. Do not paint cereal or splashes directly onto it; we need an untouched copy for the overlap effect in Step 20.
4. Compare both side edges. A band of pale ceramic must still be visible between the milk and the dark outer rim.
5. Save your front PSD. You now have a four-shape bowl structure.

Milk is not a flat white sticker

ILLUSTRATED CHECKPOINT | Compare structure, not identical filter pixels.



PSD geometry: 1800 x 2520 px | Stage 07

- 1 Inset the milk ellipse inside the rim.
- 2 Near-white centre; a cool edge suggests depth.
- 3 Keep this layer separate for the overlap mask later.

Illustrated checkpoint—not a Photoshop screenshot.

WHY

A slightly cool edge gives the milk a boundary without making it look grey throughout. The preserved ellipse will later hide part of two cereal pieces.

CHECK

The milk reads as liquid inside the rim, not a white oval pasted over the whole bowl.

FIX

If the gradient is dark in the middle, use Reverse. If the rim vanishes, the milk is too large or not positioned at the specified coordinates.

Tool reference: S2, S10. Recipe values are lesson starting points.

08

Draw the main milk splash

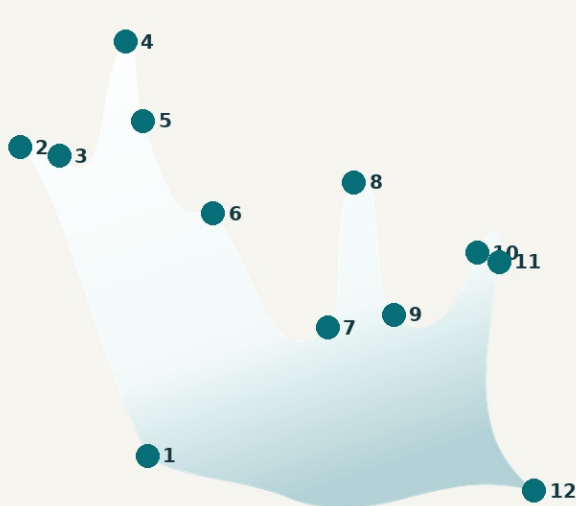
SELECT FIRST 04 MILK FRONT; turn the trace guide on temporarily.

1. Choose the Pen tool (P). In the options bar set **Shape**, Fill **#F4FBFA**, Stroke **None**, and Path Operations **New Layer**. Name the new shape **Splash main**.
2. Zoom to about 75%. Start near **(570,1810)** at the lower-left base. Follow the purple outline upward toward **(425,1460)**, around the tallest crest near **(545,1340)**, and through the remaining numbered anchors in the Splash map.
3. At a curved point, **click-drag in the direction the curve travels** instead of clicking only. Use as few anchors as possible. Close the shape by clicking the first anchor. The full anchor map is in the construction appendix.
4. Use the Direct Selection tool (white arrow, A) to move an anchor or its handle. Alt/Option-drag a handle to adjust it independently. Aim for rounded tips and generous valleys, not a perfect tracing.
5. Apply a top-to-bottom gradient: **#FFFFFF**, **#F2FAF9 at 70%**, **#B3D2D7**. Hide the guide. The splash base should overlap the milk.

Coordinates and anchor diagrams: construction appendix after Step 40.

Splash path: anchor placement and handle direction

TRACE GUIDE | Place broad anchors first; reshape curves with Direct Selection (A).



- 1 Pen tool: Shape mode, no stroke.
- 2 Click-drag to create a rounded crest.
- 3 Alt/Option adjusts one handle.
- 4 Close the path at anchor 1.
- 5 Hide the trace guide before judging.

Illustrated checkpoint—not a Photoshop screenshot.

WHY

The silhouette is the main motion cue. Drawing a new splash avoids relying on an old photograph and makes its shape editable.

CHECK

The splash grows from inside the bowl and has three readable crests. Its lower section is cooler and darker than the tips.

FIX

Too many anchors make bumps. Undo a problem point and redraw with fewer. Approved support route: place splash_support.png at approximately x410, y1325 and record its use.

Tool reference: S10. Recipe values are lesson starting points.

Build a small family of droplets

SELECT FIRST 04 MILK FRONT; create a Droplets subgroup above Splash main.

1. With the Ellipse tool in Shape mode, make **Drop 01** approximately **48 × 82 px**. Give it the same white-to-cool gradient as Splash main.
2. Use Free Transform (Ctrl/Cmd+T). Enable the reference point and choose its **centre**. Set centre **x410, y1370** and rotation **−23°**. Press Enter/Return.
3. Duplicate the droplet with Ctrl/Cmd+J. Change its size, position and rotation using the Droplet table in the construction appendix. The table lists **full widths and heights**, not radii.
4. Use about ten drops, with the biggest close to the splash and smaller ones farther away. Keep the future dinosaur-face area clear.
5. Turn the group off and on. Delete a droplet only when it adds clutter, not simply because your curve differs from the reference. Save.

Coordinates and anchor diagrams: construction appendix after Step 40.

Less spray. Better direction.

ILLUSTRATED CHECKPOINT | Compare structure, not identical filter pixels.



PSD geometry: 1800 x 2520 px | Stage 09

- 1 Large drops stay near the main splash.
- 2 Small drops extend its upward motion.
- 3 Do not cover the future mascot face.

Illustrated checkpoint—not a Photoshop screenshot.

WHY

Size and direction make separate drops read as one event. Repetition with variation is more convincing than evenly spaced dots.

CHECK

Drops follow the splash's upward motion; they do not fill every empty area.

FIX

A rotation value rotates an ellipse in the image plane, not in 3D. If coordinates move the wrong corner, select the centre reference point before entering x/y.

Tool reference: S4, S10. Recipe values are lesson starting points.

10

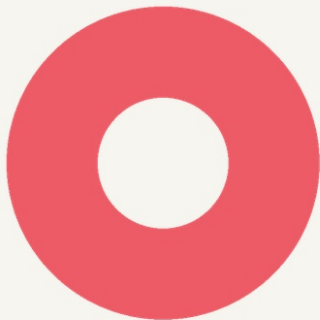
Make a ring with a real hole

SELECT FIRST A new document: File > New, 800 × 800 px, RGB/8, transparent.

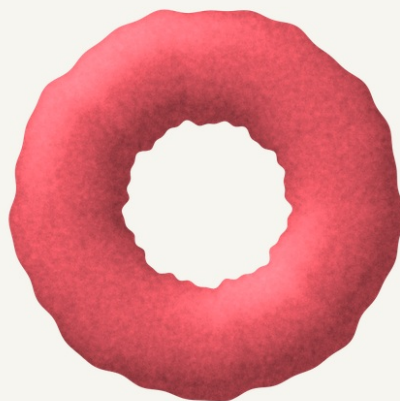
1. Save as **Working/Surname_LOOP_MASTER.psd**. Choose the Ellipse tool in Shape mode, no stroke, fill #ED5B66. Draw a **600 × 600 px** circle at **x100, y100**. Name it **Ring colour**.
2. Keep Ring colour selected. In the options bar open **Path Operations > Subtract Front Shape**. Draw a second circle on that SAME shape layer.
3. Use the white Direct Selection arrow (A) to select only the new inner path. Adjust it to **250 × 250 px**, positioned at **x275, y275**. It should remove the middle of the larger circle.
4. Switch Path Operations back to **New Layer** before drawing anything else. Hide any white Background layer. The centre must show the transparency checkerboard.
5. Fallback: draw the outer circle, select a 250 px circular marquee in its centre, invert that selection, then add a layer mask to reveal only the ring. Keep that mask editable.

Build one ring. Reuse the construction.

DIAGRAM | The shading shown is an approximation of the Photoshop layer-style result.



1. Shape + real hole



2. Light + grain

- 1 Outer circle: 600 px.
- 2 Inner hole: 250 px.
- 3 Bevel starts at 70 px.
- 4 Grain is clipped to the ring.
- 5 Keep the 800 px master.

Illustrated checkpoint—not a Photoshop screenshot.

WHY

A white painted centre is not a hole: it would cover the milk and background. Subtraction or a mask creates real transparency.

CHECK

The ring has a 600 px outer diameter and a centred 250 px hole. Only one outer shape is needed.

FIX

If you see two filled circles, you created a new layer rather than a subtracted path. Undo the inner circle and check the selected layer and Path Operations.

Tool reference: S7, S10. Recipe values are lesson starting points.

11

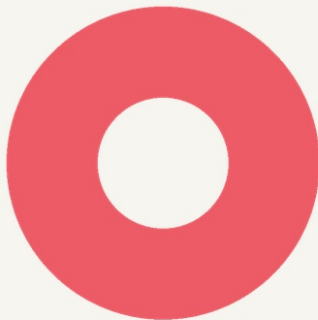
Light the ring with a bevel

SELECT FIRST Ring colour in the 800 px master document.

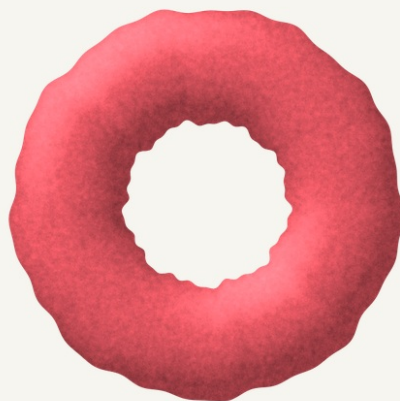
1. Double-click the empty area to the right of the layer name to open **Layer Style**. Click the words **Bevel & Emboss**, not just its checkbox.
2. Start with Style **Inner Bevel**, Technique **Smooth**, Depth **180%**, Direction **Up**, Size **70 px**, and Soften **4 px**. Keep the default smooth contour initially.
3. Set Angle **120°**, Altitude **35°**, and enable **Use Global Light**. Set Highlight Mode **Screen**, white, **70%**; Shadow Mode **Multiply**, **#22283F**, **40%**.
4. Leave Drop Shadow off on the master. Click OK. At 100% zoom, compare the flat ring with the shaded one by toggling the Bevel & Emboss eye.
5. Adjust Size between roughly **55 and 85 px** if the tube looks too flat or pinched. Preserve an open centre and a soft highlight, then save.

Build one ring. Reuse the construction.

DIAGRAM | The shading shown is an approximation of the Photoshop layer-style result.



1. Shape + real hole



2. Light + grain

- 1 Outer circle: 600 px.
- 2 Inner hole: 250 px.
- 3 Bevel starts at 70 px.
- 4 Grain is clipped to the ring.
- 5 Keep the 800 px master.

Illustrated checkpoint—not a Photoshop screenshot.

WHY

A bevel changes light and shade around the two boundaries, creating a depth illusion without generating a mesh.

CHECK

The upper-left side is brighter. You can reopen the effect under the layer to change it.

FIX

A glassy highlight is too strong for cereal. Lower Highlight opacity or Depth. These settings are starting values; the diagram is not a Photoshop-rendered preview.

Tool reference: S2. Recipe values are lesson starting points.

12

Add editable grain, not coloured static

SELECT FIRST Ring colour; remain in the 800 px master.

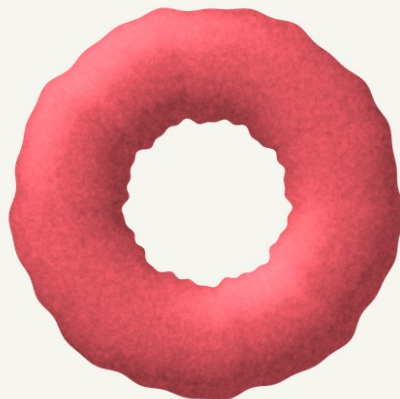
1. Create a blank pixel layer above Ring colour using **Layer > New > Layer**. Name it **Grain**. Choose **Edit > Fill > 50% Gray**, Mode Normal, Opacity 100%.
2. Right-click Grain and choose **Convert to Smart Object**. Choose **Filter > Noise > Add Noise**: Amount **12%**, Distribution **Gaussian**, and **Monochromatic** on. Click OK.
3. Choose **Filter > Blur > Gaussian Blur** and enter **0.4 px**. This softens harsh single-pixel speckles without erasing all texture.
4. Choose **Layer > Create Clipping Mask** while Grain is selected. It should indent above Ring colour. Set Grain's blend mode in Layers to **Soft Light** and opacity to **55%**.
5. Toggle Grain off/on at 100% zoom. For stronger coarse texture, place grain_tile.png above Grain, clip it too, scale it to about 200%, and use Soft Light at 15–25%. That extra tile is optional.

Build one ring. Reuse the construction.

DIAGRAM | The shading shown is an approximation of the Photoshop layer-style result.



1. Shape + real hole



2. Light + grain

- 1 Outer circle: 600 px.
- 2 Inner hole: 250 px.
- 3 Bevel starts at 70 px.
- 4 Grain is clipped to the ring.
- 5 Keep the 800 px master.

Illustrated checkpoint—not a Photoshop screenshot.

WHY

Neutral grey mostly disappears in Soft Light, while lighter and darker texture modulates the ring. Clipping keeps grain out of the hole and background.

CHECK

The ring becomes subtly rougher. There is no grey square and no red/green/blue noise.

FIX

If grey covers the document, confirm the clipping arrow and Soft Light. If clipping is absent, select Grain—not its Smart Filter mask—and use the menu again.

Tool reference: S5, S6. Recipe values are lesson starting points.

13

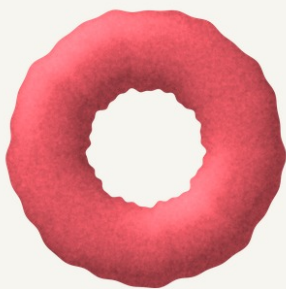
Wrap the construction in a Smart Object

SELECT FIRST The ring shape and its clipped grain layer(s).

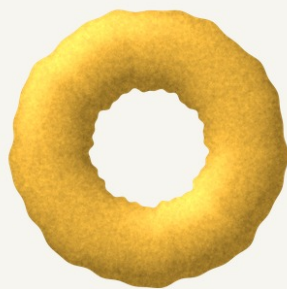
1. Shift-click to select Ring colour and its grain layers. Press **Ctrl/Cmd+G** to group them. Name the group **Ring editable source**. Do not include any background layer.
2. Duplicate the group with Ctrl/Cmd+J. Name the lower copy **BACKUP — unwarped construction** and hide it. Keep the upper copy visible.
3. Right-click the visible group and choose **Convert to Smart Object**. Name it **Loop coral master**. The small Smart Object badge appears on its thumbnail.
4. Double-click that thumbnail to inspect its contents. You should see the shape and clipped grain in a temporary document. Close the contents tab without changing anything.
5. Save LOOP_MASTER.psd. Keep this document open for the next two steps.

Shared copies versus independent flavours

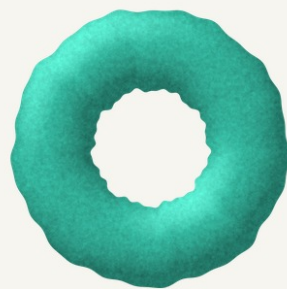
SCHEMATIC | Ctrl/Cmd+J is not the same as New Smart Object Via Copy.



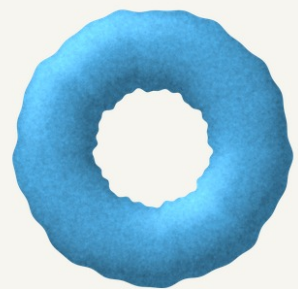
CORAL



GOLD



TEAL



BLUE

Use New Smart Object Via Copy once for each new colour. Use ordinary duplicates for repeated pieces of the SAME colour.

Illustrated checkpoint—not a Photoshop screenshot.

WHY

The outer Smart Object can be transformed and filtered while its shape, colour and grain remain editable inside.

CHECK

There is one visible ring Smart Object, plus a hidden backup group. Nothing white is visible through the hole.

FIX

If double-clicking opens Layer Style, you clicked the blank layer area. Double-click the image thumbnail to open contents. Never flatten the whole master.

Tool reference: S12, S5. Recipe values are lesson starting points.

14

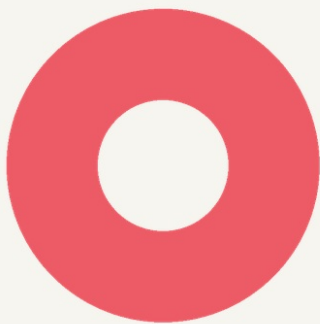
Make the outline slightly irregular

SELECT FIRST Loop coral master, not the hidden backup.

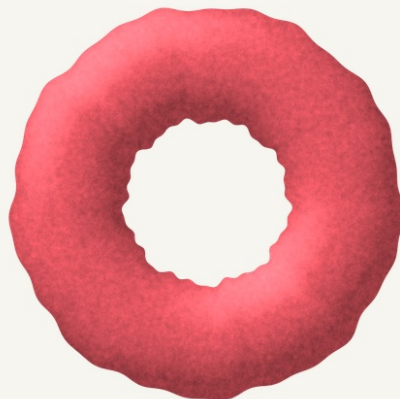
1. Choose **Filter > Liquify**. Select **Forward Warp** (W inside Liquify). Start with Brush Size **90**, Density **35** and Pressure **15**.
2. View the ring near 100%. Make six to ten very short pushes along the OUTER edge, each less than about **12 px**. Alternate a few inward and outward pushes.
3. Make only two or three smaller pushes along the inner boundary. Keep the hole open, roughly centred, and large enough to read when the ring is reduced.
4. Use the reconstruction controls or Undo for a bad push. Click OK. Liquify should now appear beneath the Smart Object as an editable Smart Filter.
5. Hide/show the Liquify filter to compare. Save the master when the ring is irregular but still recognizable.

Build one ring. Reuse the construction.

DIAGRAM | The shading shown is an approximation of the Photoshop layer-style result.



1. Shape + real hole



2. Light + grain

- 1 Outer circle: 600 px.
- 2 Inner hole: 250 px.
- 3 Bevel starts at 70 px.
- 4 Grain is clipped to the ring.
- 5 Keep the 800 px master.

Illustrated checkpoint—not a Photoshop screenshot.

WHY

Perfect circles feel manufactured as graphics. Small imperfections suggest a food surface without destroying the reusable form.

CHECK

No edge has spikes, the tube thickness stays plausible, and the centre is still transparent.

FIX

A stretched or collapsed ring usually means the pressure or movement was too large. Reset/reconstruct, lower Pressure and make shorter strokes.

Tool reference: S8, S5. Recipe values are lesson starting points.

15

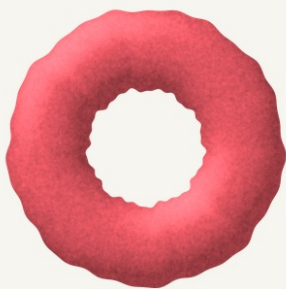
Bring an editable master into the cover

SELECT FIRST Loop coral master in LOOP_MASTER.psd.

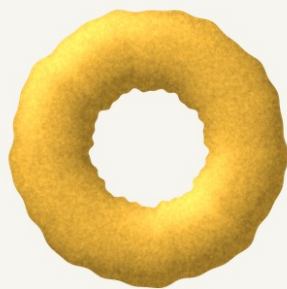
1. Right-click the layer name and choose **Duplicate Layer**. In Destination Document choose your **FRONT** PSD. Name the duplicate **MASTER coral** and click OK.
2. Switch to the FRONT tab. Move MASTER coral into **90 LOOP MASTERS**. Do not scale this stored master. Keep the group visible temporarily while making the other colours.
3. With MASTER coral selected, choose **Layer > Smart Objects > New Smart Object Via Copy**. Name the new independent object **MASTER gold**.
4. Double-click MASTER gold's thumbnail. Inside its contents, double-click the **Ring colour** fill thumbnail and change the fill to **#F3B93F**. Choose File > Save, then close the contents tab.
5. Return to the FRONT tab. Gold should change while coral stays coral. Save the front PSD.

Shared copies versus independent flavours

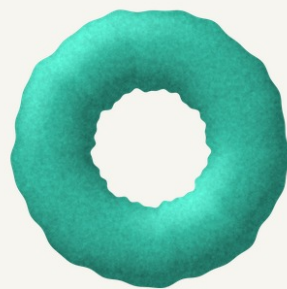
SCHEMATIC | Ctrl/Cmd+J is not the same as New Smart Object Via Copy.



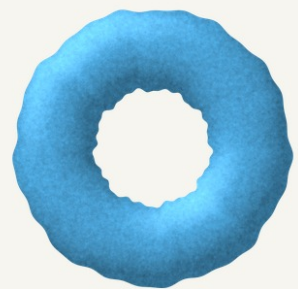
CORAL



GOLD



TEAL



BLUE

Use New Smart Object Via Copy once for each new colour. Use ordinary duplicates for repeated pieces of the SAME colour.

Illustrated checkpoint—not a Photoshop screenshot.

WHY

A new flavour needs independent contents. Ordinary duplicate instances are linked to the same embedded source; changing that source can change all of them.

CHECK

Two masters have different colours. Both still retain their editable internal construction.

FIX

If both become gold, undo the colour edit and recreate gold using New Smart Object Via Copy—not Ctrl/Cmd+J. Save and close the inner tab to update the parent.

Tool reference: S3, S12. Recipe values are lesson starting points.

16

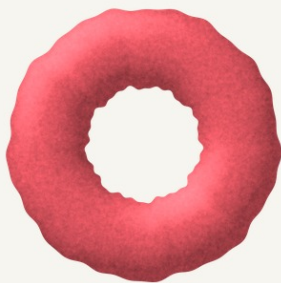
Finish the four-colour master set

SELECT FIRST 90 LOOP MASTERS in the front PSD.

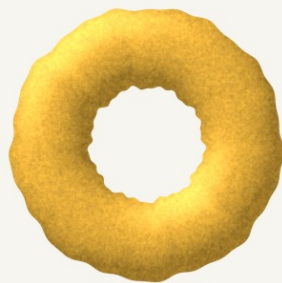
1. Select MASTER coral. Choose **Layer > Smart Objects > New Smart Object Via Copy** again. Rename this copy **MASTER teal**. Open its contents and set Ring colour to **#36B8A0**; save and close.
2. Repeat once more for **MASTER blue**, using **#4EA9DE**. Keep the same bevel settings so the four flavours share a light direction.
3. Test independence: change a master's colour briefly, save its contents, and confirm only that flavour changes. Undo inside that contents document, save, and close it.
4. In the front document, name every master clearly. Move them apart temporarily to inspect them, then hide **90 LOOP MASTERS**. The group is storage, not part of the cover.
5. Save a new version: **Surname_DinoLoops_FRONT_v02.psd**. Capture evidence of the four editable masters.

Shared copies versus independent flavours

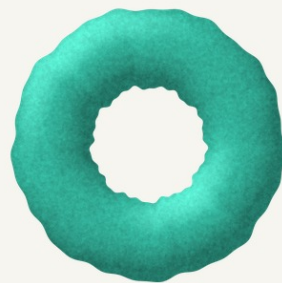
SCHEMATIC | Ctrl/Cmd+J is not the same as New Smart Object Via Copy.



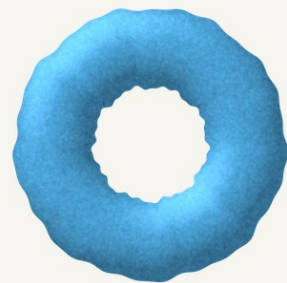
CORAL



GOLD



TEAL



BLUE

Use New Smart Object Via Copy once for each new colour. Use ordinary duplicates for repeated pieces of the SAME colour.

Illustrated checkpoint—not a Photoshop screenshot.

WHY

Building a small reusable system is more efficient and consistent than creating each food piece separately.

CHECK

Four independently coloured masters are preserved. Hiding their group removes them from the canvas.

FIX

Approved support route: Place Embedded the four loop_*_support.png files instead. These have true transparency but not the internal shape/grain layers; declare this reduced construction evidence.

Tool reference: S3. Recipe values are lesson starting points.

17

Place the first ring on the milk plane

SELECT FIRST MASTER teal inside 90 LOOP MASTERS.

1. Keep the master group hidden, but select its teal layer in Layers. Press **Ctrl/Cmd+J** to make a linked instance, then drag that copy into **03 IN-BOWL CEREAL**. Ensure its own eye and its new group eye are on. Rename it **B01 teal**.
2. Press **Ctrl/Cmd+T**. Turn the width/height link off to allow deliberate vertical squashing. Fit the **visible ring** to approximately **180 px wide × 92 px high**.
3. Choose the centre reference point and set **x510, y1810**, rotation **−12°**. Confirm. The ring now lies approximately on the shallow milk plane.
4. If the transform box includes transparent margins, use the trace/rulers to match the visible size. For a master whose box is 800 px but ring is 600 px, box dimensions are approximately the target visible dimensions × **800/600**.
5. Do not add a large Drop Shadow. Contact shading comes in Step 19.

Coordinates and anchor diagrams: construction appendix after Step 40.

Place the cereal on the milk plane

ILLUSTRATED CHECKPOINT | Compare structure, not identical filter pixels.



PSD geometry: 1800 x 2520 px | Stage 18

- 1 Squash the rings vertically, then rotate in the image plane.
- 2 Vary position, size and colour without a perfect grid.
- 3 Do not claim these transforms rotate a true 3D object.

Illustrated checkpoint—not a Photoshop screenshot.

WHY

Squashing changes the visible ellipse, suggesting a shallow viewing angle. It is a 2D approximation, not rotation of an actual 3D ring.

CHECK

The ring fits inside the milk and looks flatter than a logo ring. The master remains full-sized and hidden.

FIX

Do not use W=180% when you need a pixel target. Use explicit units or match visible bounds; the transparent canvas changes what transform dimensions mean.

Tool reference: S4, S3. Recipe values are lesson starting points.

18

Populate the bowl without making a grid

SELECT FIRST 03 IN-BOWL CEREAL; keep the masters hidden.

1. Duplicate the appropriate master into the visible cereal group for each of the remaining pieces. Use **Ctrl/Cmd+J** for repeated instances of a colour; do not create another independent master for every ring.
2. Follow the **In-bowl placement table** in the construction appendix. For each piece: set its visible width/height, select the centre reference point, then enter centre x/y and rotation.
3. Name the pieces B01–B12 with their colours. Keep all twelve within the milk surface. Some will sit behind Splash main because 04 MILK FRONT is above this group.
4. Hide the trace and look at the bowl alone. Leave some open milk between pieces; do not place every ring at an identical size or angle.
5. Make one deliberate improvement to a crowded area. The coordinates are a reproducible starting layout, not a rule that prevents better spacing. Save.

Coordinates and anchor diagrams: construction appendix after Step 40.

Place the cereal on the milk plane

ILLUSTRATED CHECKPOINT | Compare structure, not identical filter pixels.



PSD geometry: 1800 x 2520 px | Stage 18

- 1 Squash the rings vertically, then rotate in the image plane.
- 2 Vary position, size and colour without a perfect grid.
- 3 Do not claim these transforms rotate a true 3D object.

Illustrated checkpoint—not a Photoshop screenshot.

WHY

Repeated colours establish a product family, while varied positions and angles avoid a mechanical pattern.

CHECK

There are about twelve bowl pieces, four flavours, and visible milk gaps. Some cereal is naturally hidden by the splash.

FIX

A missing ring may be behind the splash or inside the hidden master group. Check layer location and visibility before duplicating another one.

Tool reference: S4, S3. Recipe values are lesson starting points.

19

Paint close contact shadows

SELECT FIRST 03 IN-BOWL CEREAL; create a pixel layer **BELOW** its cereal pieces.

1. Name the new layer **Contact shadows**. Set its blend mode to **Multiply** and opacity to **25%**. Choose foreground **#1A444F**.
2. Choose the Elliptical Marquee tool (under M). Draw a narrow ellipse immediately under B01, approximately **170 × 35 px**, with its centre slightly below and to the right of the cereal centre.
3. Choose **Edit > Fill > Foreground Color**. Deselect with Ctrl/Cmd+D. Repeat under several resting rings, keeping the shadow close to each base.
4. With Contact shadows selected, choose **Filter > Blur > Gaussian Blur**, Radius **6 px**. Because these are newly painted shadows, preserve a hidden duplicate first when experimenting with different blur values.
5. Compare at 50% zoom. Reduce the entire layer opacity if the milk looks dirty. Never paint these contact shadows under the flying cereal.

Small shadows establish contact

ILLUSTRATED CHECKPOINT | Compare structure, not identical filter pixels.



PSD geometry: 1800 x 2520 px | Stage 19

- 1 Shadows are close to resting rings.
- 2 Use cool dark tones at low opacity.
- 3 No bowl-contact shadow belongs under an airborne ring.

Illustrated checkpoint—not a Photoshop screenshot.

WHY

A small shadow suggests that cereal touches the milk. A large detached shadow instead makes it seem to hover.

CHECK

Each shadow is subtle, close to a resting piece, and below the coloured ring layer.

FIX

If a dark mark covers a ring, Contact shadows is too high in the stack. If every ring appears to float, reduce both shadow offset and blur.

Tool reference: S2. Recipe values are lesson starting points.

Sink two cereal edges into the milk

SELECT FIRST Milk surface in 02 BOWL; select the layer, not its vector path.

1. Press **Ctrl/Cmd+J** to duplicate Milk surface. Move the copy into **04 MILK FRONT**, BELOW Splash main and droplets but ABOVE the in-bowl cereal group. Name it **Milk overlap**. Do not move or resize it.
2. Choose **Select > Deselect**. Hold **Alt/Option** while clicking Add Layer Mask at the bottom of Layers. This adds a black raster mask; the duplicate milk disappears.
3. Click that new **black mask thumbnail**. Choose Brush (B), a soft round tip, foreground white, Opacity **35%**, Flow **30%**, size about **30–45 px**.
4. Paint a short white stroke over the lower edge of B01 teal near **(510,1849)**. Then paint a smaller strip over B07 teal near **(960,1922)**. Build slowly until milk covers only the bottom few pixels.
5. Press X to switch to black and hide excess overlap. Leave the ring's central hole and most of its body visible. Save.

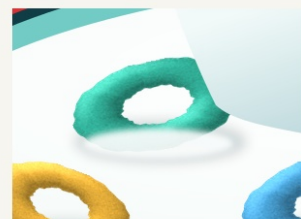
The milk-overlap mask: reveal a little, not the whole layer

DETAIL | White on the mask reveals the duplicate milk. Black hides it.



BEFORE: sits on top

Select the mask thumbnail. Use a small white soft brush only along the lower edge. Do not paint on the cereal pixels.



AFTER: lower edge enters milk

Illustrated checkpoint—not a Photoshop screenshot.

WHY

The exact same milk pixels reappear above the cereal. This creates occlusion without erasing a ring or trying to hand-match the liquid colour.

CHECK

Two pieces appear slightly submerged. Toggling Milk overlap reveals the original full pieces underneath.

FIX

A white-painted mark means the image, not mask, was selected. Undo immediately, select the black raster-mask thumbnail, and paint again. A white mask reveals too much milk.

Tool reference: S7. Recipe values are lesson starting points.

21

Send a few rings into the air

SELECT FIRST 05 FLYING CEREAL, above the splash group.

1. Duplicate six instances from the hidden masters into this group. Rename them **F01** through **F06** with their colours.
2. Use the **Flying placement table** in the appendix. Give each ring a different visible height and rotation; airborne pieces can be more upright than the rings resting on milk.
3. Keep these pieces in front of the splash by leaving their group above 04 MILK FRONT. The gold piece near **(500,1490)** should visibly cross a splash edge.
4. Leave Drop Shadow off for these isolated flying rings. They are not sitting on the background. Their existing surface shading is sufficient for this illustration.
5. Look at the path from the bowl through the flying pieces. Remove or reposition a piece that blocks an important detail. Save.

Coordinates and anchor diagrams: construction appendix after Step 40.

Depth is a layer-order decision

ILLUSTRATED CHECKPOINT | Compare structure, not identical filter pixels.



PSD geometry: 1800 x 2520 px | Stage 21

- 1 Milk overlaps resting cereal.
- 2 Splash passes in front of some rings.
- 3 Flying cereal has its own foreground group.

Illustrated checkpoint—not a Photoshop screenshot.

WHY

Overlap, scale and orientation establish foreground movement. The layer stack is responsible for much of the apparent depth.

CHECK

The milk is behind some flying pieces and in front of some resting pieces. Empty space remains for the mascot's face.

FIX

A floating ring with a dark shadow directly behind it looks glued to the red background. Remove the shadow, not the ring's bevel shading.

Tool reference: S4. Recipe values are lesson starting points.

Build an original dinosaur silhouette

SELECT FIRST 01 MASCOT; turn the tracing guide on.

1. Use Shape mode, no stroke, fill **#F6AE38**. Make the body ellipse at **x315, y1290, w800, h620**. Name it **Dino body**.
2. Make a rounded rectangle for **Dino neck: x820, y1085, w290, h710**, corner radius approximately **145 px**. Put it above the body.
3. Create **Dino head** as an ellipse at **x785, y955, w520, h335**, above the neck. These final positions leave a clear band below the tagline.
4. With the Pen tool in Shape mode, trace the tail below the body layer. Start near **(550,1640)**, curve left toward **(135,1375)**, then return along the upper contour toward **(555,1495)**. Close the shape inside the body where the join will be hidden.
5. Turn off the trace. Keep all four layers in 01 MASCOT, BEHIND the bowl. This generic shape character is original to the classroom lesson.

An original mascot, built from shapes

ILLUSTRATED CHECKPOINT | Compare structure, not identical filter pixels.



PSD geometry: 1800 x 2520 px | Stage 22

- 1 Tail, body, neck and head remain separate.
- 2 The bowl conceals the lower body.
- 3 Do not use the cartoon character from the supplied screenshot.

Illustrated checkpoint—not a Photoshop screenshot.

WHY

Overlapping simple shapes can create a readable mascot without importing a copyrighted character or flattening an illustration.

CHECK

The head clears the future tagline, the neck joins the body, and the bowl hides the lower body.

FIX

A seam in the silhouette means shapes do not overlap enough. Extend the hidden neck/body overlap rather than painting over the join on a merged layer.

Tool reference: S10. Recipe values are lesson starting points.

23

Shade the dinosaur and add a belly

SELECT FIRST 01 MASCOT; work on one named shape at a time.

1. Give tail, body, neck and head a warm diagonal gradient: **#FFDC6A at 0%**, **#FBB53D at 55%**, and **#E87627 at 100%**. Orient the bright side toward the upper left.
2. Create **Dino belly** above the body: ellipse **x506, y1395, w530, h470**. Use a gradient from **#FFEAA0** to **#FFC856**, with layer opacity about **85%**.
3. Add five small ellipses named **Spots**, using **#D97A2B** at about **45%** opacity. Suggested centres are **(473,1495)**, **(515,1445)**, **(587,1420)**, **(671,1425)**, **(865,1327)**; vary sizes from 40 to 85 px.
4. Keep the spots inside the silhouette. The belly may cover part of a body spot; arrange their order intentionally rather than merging.
5. Compare the neck/head join at normal viewing size. Adjust gradient direction or stops if a sudden dark band makes the head look detached.

Shade the same character consistently

ILLUSTRATED CHECKPOINT | Compare structure, not identical filter pixels.



PSD geometry: 1800 x 2520 px | Stage 23

- 1 Use warm highlight-to-shadow gradients.
- 2 A lighter belly separates the chest from the body.
- 3 Details stay simple enough to read at reduced size.

Illustrated checkpoint—not a Photoshop screenshot.

WHY

Consistent warm shading gives the mascot volume. A lighter belly separates its large body shapes while keeping the design simple.

CHECK

All bright areas suggest the same upper-left light. Spots look like decoration on the character, not holes.

FIX

A gradient reset can flip a shape's light. Reopen that shape's Fill controls and match the visible direction instead of trusting a copied angle number.

Tool reference: S2, S10. Recipe values are lesson starting points.

24

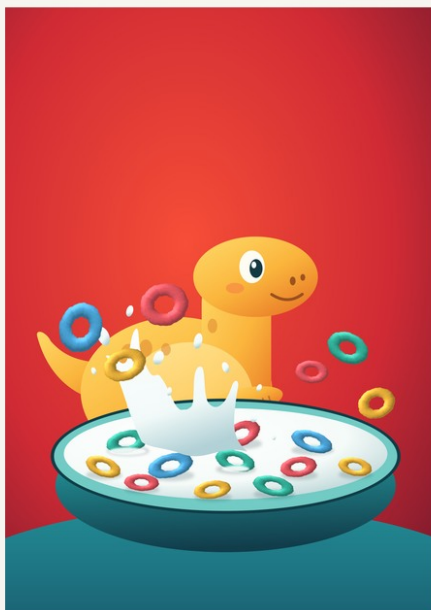
Give the mascot a face and an arm

SELECT FIRST 01 MASCOT; create Face above the head layer.

1. Make a cream eye ellipse centred at **(1030,1081)**, size **106 × 136 px**. Add a navy pupil centred at **(1047,1088)**, size **54 × 78 px**, then a white highlight at **(1038,1073)**, size **20 × 28 px**.
2. Add two dark-brown nostrils at **(1200,1140)** and **(1242,1125)**, approximately **24 × 36** and **20 × 28 px**. Use **#9C541F**.
3. For the smile, choose the Pen tool in Shape mode, **Fill None**, Stroke **#995020**, **12 px**. Draw an open curved path from **(1112,1196)**, dipping near **(1180,1220)**, to **(1240,1195)**. Use round end caps.
4. Add a cheek ellipse at centre **(959,1170)**, size **76 × 44 px**, fill **#F88B45**, opacity 70%.
5. Create an arm ellipse centred at **(975,1650)**, size **376 × 118 px**, rotated **−13°**. Apply the warm gradient. Optional: add two short 7 px brown finger strokes; the bowl conceals much of the arm.

Expression needs only a few marks

ILLUSTRATED CHECKPOINT | Compare structure, not identical filter pixels.



PSD geometry: 1800 x 2520 px | Stage 24

- 1 An eye and a highlight establish the gaze.
- 2 The smile is on a separate layer.
- 3 Move the eye before adding extra decoration.

Illustrated checkpoint—not a Photoshop screenshot.

WHY

A few contrasting marks carry expression at small sizes. Keeping each mark editable makes revisions to the gaze and smile easy.

CHECK

The eye is readable at 25% zoom. The arm is behind the bowl, not floating over the milk.

FIX

For a smile that fills as a triangle, change Fill to None. For the wrong gaze, move the pupil within the eye instead of adding extra eyes or details.

Tool reference: S10, S4. Recipe values are lesson starting points.

25

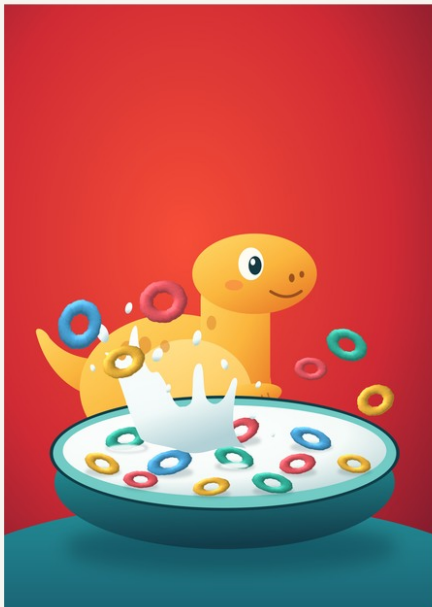
Ground the bowl and audit the scene

SELECT FIRST 02 BOWL; create a blank pixel layer **BELOW** Bowl body.

1. Name the layer **Bowl ground shadow**. With the Elliptical Marquee tool draw a wide flat ellipse from approximately **x260, y2170** to **x1630, y2350**.
2. Fill it with **#052738** using Edit > Fill > Foreground Color, then deselect. Right-click the layer and choose **Convert to Smart Object**.
3. Choose **Filter > Blur > Gaussian Blur**, Radius **36 px**. Set layer opacity to about **35%**. Keep the layer under the bowl body but above the background group.
4. Check the group order against the layer-stack diagram: mascot behind bowl; resting cereal above milk; overlap and splash above resting cereal; flying cereal in front.
5. Save **Surname_DinoLoops_FRONT_v03.psd**. Take an evidence image showing the scene and expanded layer groups before adding the wordmark.

Ground the scene, keep the edits

ILLUSTRATED CHECKPOINT | Compare structure, not identical filter pixels.



PSD geometry: 1800 x 2520 px | Stage 25

- 1 The bowl shadow belongs **BELOW** the bowl.
- 2 The mascot stays behind the food.
- 3 Save a checkpoint before lettering.

Illustrated checkpoint—not a Photoshop screenshot.

WHY

The shadow connects the bowl to the table. This is a separate relationship from cereal touching milk and should not be painted on the same shadow layer.

CHECK

The bowl has a subtle grounded base; the character is behind it. No guide or master rings appear in the artwork.

FIX

A very dark oval distracts from the product. Lower opacity before increasing blur. If the shadow covers the bowl, move its layer below Bowl body.

Tool reference: S5. Recipe values are lesson starting points.

26

Set the six live letters

SELECT FIRST 06 WORDMARK; create a Letters subgroup.

1. Choose the Horizontal Type tool (T). Pick an installed heavy sans-serif such as **Arial Black** or a bold alternative. Set colour **#FFFCEB**; start around **340 px** in the size field. Fonts are not bundled.
2. Click once and type **D**. Confirm using the options-bar checkmark or Ctrl/Cmd+Enter. Rename the Type layer **D face**. Repeat for separate **I, N, L, P, S** layers.
3. Use the **Letter layout table** to fit each letter's visible box. Choose Edit > Free Transform and position each live letter; keep its internal hole open and avoid extreme distortion.
4. Leave one ring-sized gap after DIN and two after L. Do NOT type the O letters: cereal will complete **DINO** and **LOOPS**.
5. Before adding effects, look at the two rows at 25%. Similar cap heights and consistent gaps matter more than matching a particular installed font. Save.

Coordinates and anchor diagrams: construction appendix after Step 40.

Leave deliberate gaps for the O letters

ILLUSTRATED CHECKPOINT | Compare structure, not identical filter pixels.



PSD geometry: 1800 x 2520 px | Stage 26

- 1 D, I, N and L, P, S are separate live Type layers.
- 2 The gaps are intentional: rings will replace the O letters.
- 3 Start with simple spacing before adding effects.

Illustrated checkpoint—not a Photoshop screenshot.

WHY

Using separate letters allows a lively arrangement while keeping spelling editable. Planned gaps let the product become part of the brand.

CHECK

Six live Type layers are present, each with a T thumbnail. The missing three O letters are intentional.

FIX

A different font will not match the reference exactly. Fit the visible boxes using the guide. Do not rasterize type to solve spacing or size problems.

Tool reference: S4. Recipe values are lesson starting points.

27

Give the letters a controlled depth edge

SELECT FIRST D face; style one letter before repeating.

1. Open Layer Style by double-clicking beside the layer name. Add **Stroke**: Size **6 px**, Position **Outside**, Blend Mode Normal, colour **#153842**.
2. Add a restrained **Bevel & Emboss**: Inner Bevel, Smooth, Depth **80%**, Size **5 px**, Soften **1 px**, Angle **120°**, Altitude **35°**. Use white Screen highlight 35% and navy Multiply shadow 20%. Click OK.
3. Duplicate D face. Name the lower copy **D depth** and drag it below the face. Clear its Layer Style from the right-click menu, change its type colour to navy, and apply only the same navy 6 px Stroke.
4. With Move tool (V), shift D depth **10 px right and 14 px down** using arrow keys. The face stays in its original location. Group the two layers as **D letter**.
5. Repeat for the other five letters. Copy/Paste Layer Style can transfer the face effects; construct each depth copy separately. Keep every depth direction the same.

Dimensional type without a 3D menu

ILLUSTRATED CHECKPOINT | Compare structure, not identical filter pixels.



PSD geometry: 1800 x 2520 px | Stage 27

- 1 A dark offset copy creates a readable depth edge.
- 2 A shallow bevel lights the cream face.
- 3 All letters share the same lighting direction.

Illustrated checkpoint—not a Photoshop screenshot.

WHY

A dark offset silhouette supplies most of the depth. A shallow bevel adds a highlight without turning the wordmark into glossy metal.

CHECK

Each letter has a cream face and a consistent lower-right navy edge. Both copies remain live type.

FIX

A later spelling change must be made in both the face and depth layers. If the depth looks detached, reduce its offset rather than adding another shadow.

Tool reference: S2. Recipe values are lesson starting points.

Replace all three O letters with cereal

SELECT FIRST 06 WORDMARK; make a Cereal O subgroup above the backing position.

1. Duplicate a coral, teal and gold master into Cereal O. Name them **O_DINO coral**, **O_LOOPS_1 teal** and **O_LOOPS_2 gold**. Do not recolour shared master contents here.
2. Fit coral to a visible **330 × 325 px** at centre (**1260,330**), rotation **−5°**. Fit teal to **315 × 300 px** at (**535,655**), rotation **10°**. Fit gold to **315 × 300 px** at (**865,655**), rotation **−12°**.
3. Open each O layer's Layer Style and add a subtle **Drop Shadow**: Multiply navy, opacity **25%**, Angle **120°**, Distance **14 px**, Spread **0%**, Size **12 px**. These are logo-object shadows, not airborne scene shadows.
4. Read the words aloud: **DINO LOOPS**. Adjust neighbouring letters slightly if the cereal reads as punctuation or decoration rather than an O.
5. Take a close-up evidence image of the wordmark and save.

Use the product as part of the name

ILLUSTRATED CHECKPOINT | Compare structure, not identical filter pixels.



- 1 One cereal O completes DINO.
- 2 Two cereal O letters complete LOOPS.
- 3 Oversized logo rings have their own subtle shadows.

PSD geometry: 1800 x 2520 px | Stage 28

Illustrated checkpoint—not a Photoshop screenshot.

WHY

Product-as-letter imagery connects the name to the food. It also lets you reuse the cereal construction at a larger scale.

CHECK

There are exactly three cereal O letters. Their holes show the background, and both words read instantly.

FIX

Opaque white centres mean your ring construction was not transparent. Repair the master hole; do not paint the background colour into individual copies.

Tool reference: S2, S4. Recipe values are lesson starting points.

29

Unify the wordmark with a backing panel

SELECT FIRST 06 WORDMARK; select its lowest visible layer.

1. Choose the Rectangle tool (U) in Shape mode. Make a rounded rectangle named **Logo backing** at **x88, y122, w1624, h737**. Set all corner radii to about **96 px**.
2. Set Fill to **#9D2230** and Stroke to **#FFC858**, width **10 px**. Keep opacity at 100% initially.
3. Drag Logo backing to the **bottom of 06 WORDMARK**, below every letter and cereal O. Keep the whole wordmark group above the mascot.
4. Inspect all four corners. No face or cereal ring should touch the border; preserve at least a small visual breathing space.
5. Toggle the backing off and on. Keep it because it organizes the name, not merely because the reference has one. Save.

A backing panel unifies the wordmark

ILLUSTRATED CHECKPOINT | Compare structure, not identical filter pixels.



PSD geometry: 1800 x 2520 px | Stage 29

- 1 Place the panel **BEHIND** every letter and ring.
- 2 Keep an even breathing space around the logo.
- 3 Its outline must not cut through a letter.

Illustrated checkpoint—not a Photoshop screenshot.

WHY

A shared backing makes several independently tilted objects read as one brand rather than scattered pieces.

CHECK

The border encloses both rows, every letter stays in front, and the red background is visible outside the panel.

FIX

If letters vanish, the backing is above them. If the border intersects a letter, fix its position or reduce the letter slightly before thickening the panel.

Tool reference: S10. Recipe values are lesson starting points.

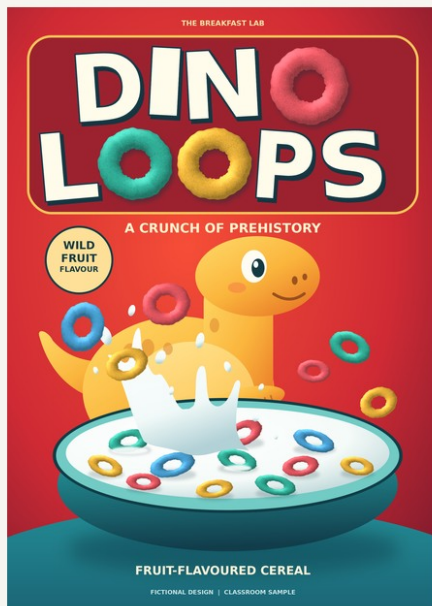
Add copy with a clear hierarchy

SELECT FIRST 07 COPY; use separate Type and Shape layers.

1. Create a small centred line **THE BREAKFAST LAB** near **x900, y65**, about **30 px**, bold, cream. The y positions here are approximate baseline targets; judge visible spacing.
2. Add **A CRUNCH OF PREHISTORY** centred near **x900, y900**, approximately **54 px**, bold, cream. Keep it between the backing and the dinosaur head without touching either.
3. Make a circular badge centred at **(300,1055)**, diameter **278 px**, Fill **#FFE098**, Stroke navy **8 px**. Add three centred live lines: **WILD / FRUIT / FLAVOUR**, navy, roughly 40–46 px.
4. At the bottom, add **FRUIT-FLAVOURED CEREAL** centred near **y2330**, about **49 px**. Add **FICTIONAL DESIGN | CLASSROOM SAMPLE** near **y2430**, about **25 px**.
5. Use the Move tool alignment controls with a full-canvas selection to centre chosen text layers; then deselect. Do not invent nutrition, certification or health claims.

The copy has different jobs

ILLUSTRATED CHECKPOINT | Compare structure, not identical filter pixels.



PSD geometry: 1800 x 2520 px | Stage 30

- 1 Name first, mascot and product second.
- 2 One short line describes the idea.
- 3 Mark the design as a fictional classroom sample.

Illustrated checkpoint—not a Photoshop screenshot.

WHY

Each text element has a job: maker, name, story, flavour and classroom identification. Different sizes help readers distinguish those jobs.

CHECK

The name dominates. The tagline has a clean red gap behind it, and the footer does not touch the canvas edge.

FIX

Crowded copy needs fewer words or more space, not extra effects. A changed font may need a smaller size or wider box to remain on one line.

Tool reference: S4. Recipe values are lesson starting points.

31

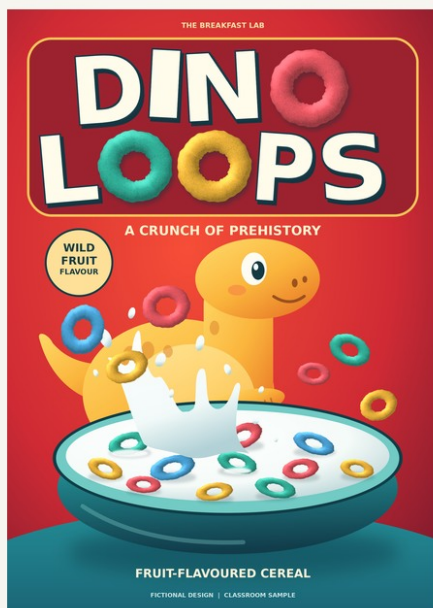
Add one restrained finishing highlight

SELECT FIRST 02 BOWL; create a highlight layer above Bowl body but below the rim.

1. Choose the Pen tool (P), Shape mode, **Fill None**, Stroke **#8FDDD5**, width **18 px**, round caps. Name the layer **Bowl highlight**.
2. Draw an open curve from about **(315,2070)**, bending through the lower-left bowl area toward **(985,2220)**. Use only two or three curve anchors; keep the stroke on the visible bowl body.
3. Lower the highlight layer opacity to about **32%**. Toggle it off/on. It should define the bowl curve, not look like a neon stripe.
4. Review the ring highlights, mascot gradients and wordmark edges together. Correct any effect that suggests light from a contradictory direction.
5. Leave space alone when it is already doing its job. Do not add a flare, extra splash or texture merely to fill the canvas.

Polish without overworking

ILLUSTRATED CHECKPOINT | Compare structure, not identical filter pixels.



PSD geometry: 1800 x 2520 px | Stage 31

- 1 One restrained highlight defines the bowl curve.
- 2 No decoration should compete with the wordmark.
- 3 Check the same light direction across the whole design.

Illustrated checkpoint—not a Photoshop screenshot.

WHY

One controlled accent can describe a curve. Consistent lighting is more convincing than a large number of unrelated effects.

CHECK

The bowl highlight is subdued and follows the form. The wordmark remains the strongest element.

FIX

An open path that creates a filled wedge has Fill enabled. Set Fill None; keep only Stroke and the reduced opacity.

Tool reference: S2, S10. Recipe values are lesson starting points.

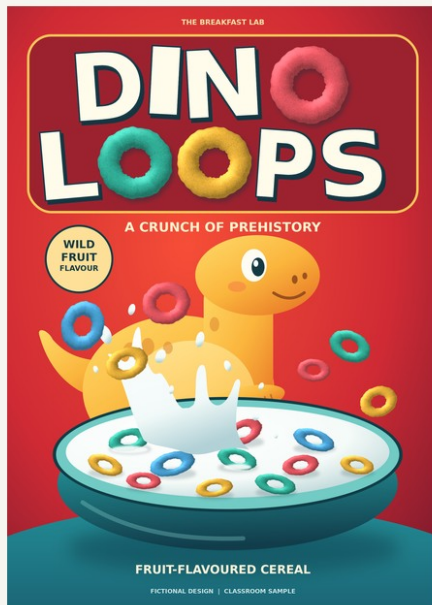
Check colour without tinting the milk

SELECT FIRST A specific object that needs correction; never start with a global colour wash.

1. Compare the design at 25% and 100%. Identify ONE issue: for example, a mascot that disappears into the background, or cereal that is much darker than the logo rings.
2. For an individual object instance, select that object and choose **Layer > New Adjustment Layer > Hue/Saturation**. Name it for its target, such as **Adjust F01 only**.
3. Keep the adjustment immediately above its target. Choose **Layer > Create Clipping Mask**. Start at **Hue 0, Saturation 0, Lightness 0**, then make a small purposeful change; try Saturation within -10 to +10 before more extreme edits.
4. Toggle the adjustment off/on. The target should change but the milk, text and background should not. Reset or delete the adjustment if it does not improve the design.
5. Record the problem, the value you tried and the result. A justified decision to leave the colour unchanged is acceptable.

Polish without overworking

ILLUSTRATED CHECKPOINT | Compare structure, not identical filter pixels.



PSD geometry: 1800 x 2520 px | Stage 31

- 1 One restrained highlight defines the bowl curve.
- 2 No decoration should compete with the wordmark.
- 3 Check the same light direction across the whole design.

Illustrated checkpoint—not a Photoshop screenshot.

WHY

A targeted correction preserves the relationships that already work. White milk is an especially useful check against an unnecessary global colour cast.

CHECK

The correction affects only the intended object. No unplanned coloured tint appears in the milk or cream type.

FIX

If the whole cover changes, the adjustment is not clipped to the right base layer. Drag it directly above its target and create the clipping mask again.

Tool reference: S6. Recipe values are lesson starting points.

33

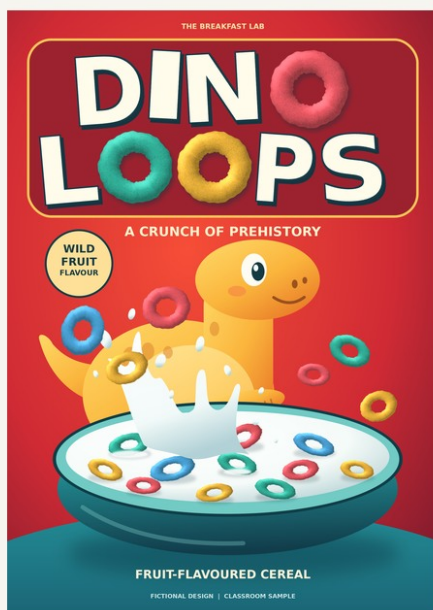
Run the five-second readability test

SELECT FIRST The front PSD at about 10% zoom; hide all guides.

1. Type **10%** into the document zoom field. The image should be thumbnail-sized. Look away, then look back for five seconds.
2. Ask a partner to say the name and identify the product without zooming in. Ask what they noticed first, second and third. Record their actual answer—not the intended answer.
3. Fix one problem using the relevant layer: tighten a gap, separate two O rings, reduce a badge, move a flying ring off the face, or simplify competing copy.
4. Keep a before and after image in **Evidence**. Write one sentence linking the edit to the feedback, such as “I moved the first cereal O closer to L so **LOOPS** read as one word.”
5. Return to Fit on Screen with **Ctrl/Cmd+0**. Save the revised PSD.

The complete illustrated front panel

ILLUSTRATED CHECKPOINT | Compare structure, not identical filter pixels.



PSD geometry: 1800 x 2520 px | Stage 36

- 1 This is the outcome of the core route.
- 2 Explain your changes instead of chasing identical pixels.
- 3 Export the flat panel before the optional mockup.

Illustrated checkpoint—not a Photoshop screenshot.

WHY

A cover must communicate before its fine details are appreciated. Reduced-size testing reveals hierarchy and spacing problems.

CHECK

A viewer can read **DINO LOOPS** and identify cereal promptly. Your revision addresses a recorded observation.

FIX

Do not respond to every suggestion by making everything bigger. Decide which element deserves attention and reduce a competing element when needed.

Evidence and design guidance are the proposed classroom framework.

34

Inspect edges, holes and layer structure

SELECT FIRST The front PSD at 100%, then 200% for selected details.

1. Inspect each cereal hole against both milk and red areas. The visible colour must come from the layer behind it; no white disc or grey square should remain.
2. Inspect the milk-overlap mask at 200%. Paint black on its raster mask to remove oversized white patches. Keep only a short soft overlap at the lower edge of two rings.
3. Check logo borders, the splash base, dinosaur joins, and the bowl highlight for stray pixels or shapes extending beyond their intended surfaces.
4. Open each main group. Confirm meaningful names, live Type layers, editable shape layers, retained Smart Object masters and a hidden trace. Delete only genuinely unused trials; do not delete your master backups.
5. Save **Surname_DinoLoops_FRONT_FINAL.psd**. Capture one layer-stack evidence image with the project visible.

The layer stack is your depth map

SCHEMATIC | Top rows render in front. The guide sits at the top only while tracing.

07 COPY + LABELS

06 WORDMARK: letters / cereal O / backing

05 FLYING CEREAL

04 MILK FRONT: droplets / splash / overlap

03 IN-BOWL CEREAL + contact shadows

02 BOWL: milk / rim / body / ground shadow

01 MASCOT: face / arm / head / neck / body / tail

00 BACKGROUND: tabletop / radial background

90 LOOP MASTERS (hidden)

99 TRACE GUIDE (hidden, at top while tracing)

Illustrated checkpoint—not a Photoshop screenshot.

WHY

A polished preview can hide a fragile construction. Edge inspection and layer organization show that the design remains editable.

CHECK

The guide and master group are hidden. There are no opaque holes, accidental duplicate letters or visible construction lines.

FIX

A flattened layer can look correct but cannot demonstrate the required process. Return to the latest layered PSD rather than rebuilding from an exported PNG.

Tool reference: S7. Recipe values are lesson starting points.

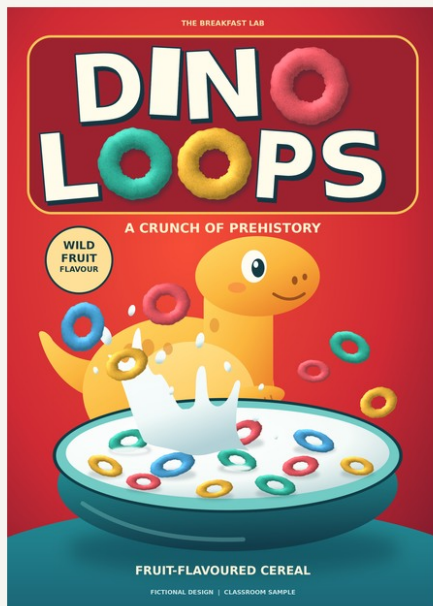
Export the front and reopen it

SELECT FIRST Surname_DinoLoops_FRONT_FINAL.psd, saved with all layers.

1. Choose **File > Export > Export As**. Select **PNG**, Scale **1x / 100%**, and confirm **1800 × 2520 px**. The full background means transparency is not required in this final panel.
2. Enable **Convert to sRGB** and **Embed Color Profile** when those options appear. Keep the layered PSD separately; exporting does not replace it.
3. Export to **Exports/Surname_DinoLoops_FRONT.png**. Open the exported file in Photoshop or a normal image viewer and inspect the complete image, dimensions and small text.
4. For a classroom paper print, $1800 \div 300 = 6$ inches and $2520 \div 300 = 8.4$ inches. A larger print may need a different resolution decision; do not enlarge silently and claim more detail.
5. Commercial production would require a printer-supplied size, dieline, bleed and colour specification. This lesson does not supply those requirements or a legally complete food label.

The complete illustrated front panel

ILLUSTRATED CHECKPOINT | Compare structure, not identical filter pixels.



PSD geometry: 1800 x 2520 px | Stage 36

- 1 This is the outcome of the core route.
- 2 Explain your changes instead of chasing identical pixels.
- 3 Export the flat panel before the optional mockup.

Illustrated checkpoint—not a Photoshop screenshot.

WHY

Reopening tests the actual submitted output, not just the editable working view. Pixel dimensions are a more dependable check than an export filename.

CHECK

The PNG opens correctly, has no guide lines or missing objects, and remains 1800 × 2520 px.

FIX

If export is cropped or resized, check the dimensions and whether an accidental selection/artboard was exported. Preserve the PSD before changing document size.

Tool reference: S9. Recipe values are lesson starting points.

36

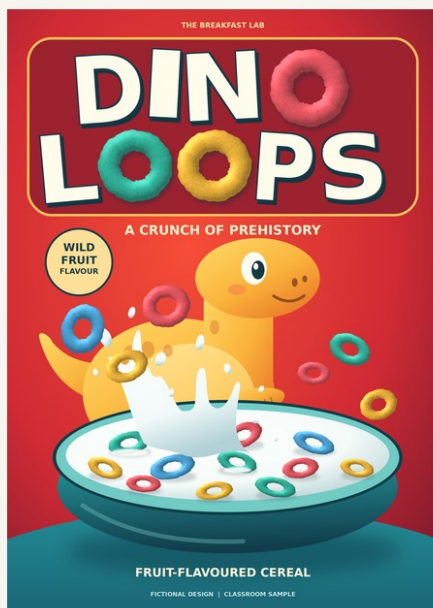
Submit evidence and explain your decisions

SELECT FIRST Your Working, Exports and Evidence folders; the process notes in this guide.

1. Submit **FRONT_FINAL.psd** and **FRONT.png**. Include three evidence images: **ring construction**, **milk-overlap/layer order**, and **readability revision before/after**.
2. Answer: “How do light, squash and overlap make the cereal feel dimensional?” Refer to two specific named layers or settings rather than saying only that it looks 3D.
3. Answer: “Which design decision helps the name read first? What changed after feedback, and why?” Use your before/after evidence.
4. Declare any prepared assets used. Distinguish **my drawn construction**, **provided support asset**, and **my adaptation**. Do not claim you built a supplied PNG from shapes.
5. Use **Export notes** in the HTML guide and save the text file in Evidence. Browser notes are not automatically sent to your teacher. The optional box mockup begins next; the core front is complete.

The complete illustrated front panel

ILLUSTRATED CHECKPOINT | Compare structure, not identical filter pixels.



PSD geometry: 1800 x 2520 px | Stage 36

- 1 This is the outcome of the core route.
- 2 Explain your changes instead of chasing identical pixels.
- 3 Export the flat panel before the optional mockup.

Illustrated checkpoint—not a Photoshop screenshot.

WHY

Evidence makes the invisible reasoning and editable workflow assessable, not just the final surface appearance.

CHECK

Your teacher can open the output and identify what you built, what you revised and what help you used.

FIX

A PNG alone does not prove layer construction. A browser progress tick is not a submission; save and send the actual files requested by your teacher.

Evidence and design guidance are the proposed classroom framework.

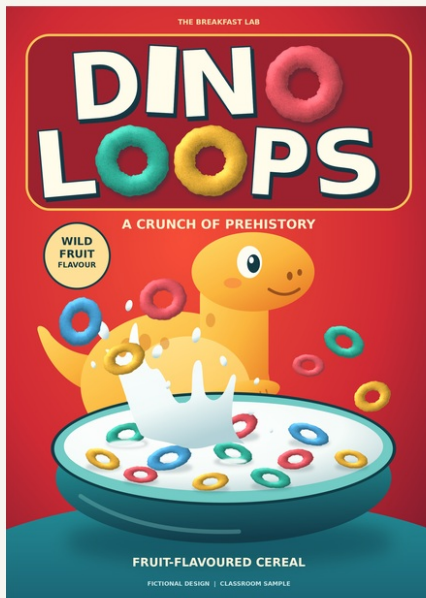
Prepare an optional presentation mockup

SELECT FIRST A completed front PNG; begin a separate Photoshop document.

1. Choose **File > New: 2200 × 2200 px**, RGB/8, sRGB, 300 ppi. Save as **Working/Surname_DinoLoops MOCKUP.psd**. Fill the background #EEF3EF.
2. Place **mockup_trace_2200x2200.png** using **File > Place Embedded**. Set its dimensions to exactly 2200 × 2200 px with top-left x0,y0. Name it **TRACE mockup**, opacity 35%, and keep it at the top.
3. Choose **File > Place Embedded** again and select **your own FRONT.png**, not the finished teacher reference. Name the new Smart Object **Front panel**.
4. Read the corner diagram. The front will join **A-B-C-D**; the side will join **B-F-G-C**; the top will join **A-E-F-B**.
5. This is a presentation image assembled from flat panels. It is not a 3D model or a box you can cut out and fold.

A flat cover becomes a perspective presentation

OPTIONAL EXTENSION | Three distorted 2D panels, not a 3D model or a print dieline.



Illustrated checkpoint—not a Photoshop screenshot.

WHY

A separate mockup protects the flat design and demonstrates how the front could read on a box-shaped object.

CHECK

The new document is square, the trace aligns with the canvas, and your own front is embedded as a Smart Object.

FIX

Do not transform your only layered front document into a slanted box. Work in this separate PSD so the original panel remains usable.

Tool reference: S12. Recipe values are lesson starting points.

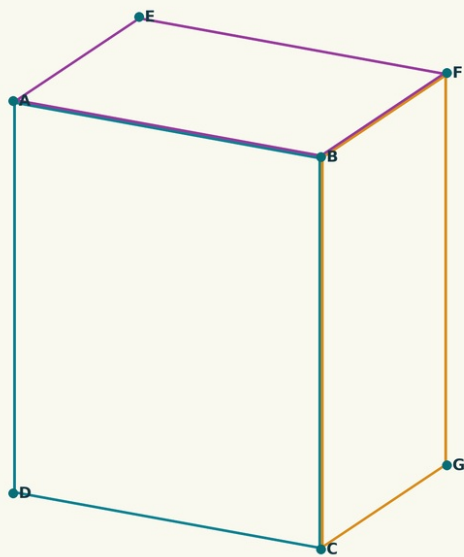
Fit the front to four exact corners

SELECT FIRST Front panel Smart Object in the mockup PSD.

1. Press **Ctrl/Cmd+T**. Right-click inside the transform box and choose **Distort**. Keep the transform active while adjusting all four corners.
2. Drag the front image's **top-left to A(350,450)**, **top-right to B(1450,650)**, **bottom-right to C(1450,2050)**, and **bottom-left to D(350,1850)**. Follow the labelled trace intersections.
3. Zoom in as needed while transforming. Hold Space to pan; release it before dragging another handle. Press Enter/Return only when the corners fit.
4. Check the words: they should be slanted with the entire front, not individually warped. Do not stretch separate letters after the panel is transformed.
5. Keep Front panel embedded. To update it later, export a new flat front and use **Layer > Smart Objects > Replace Contents** on this layer; keep the replacement's dimensions the same.

Shared corners make the mockup believable

COORDINATE DIAGRAM | Front, side and top meet at exactly the same B and F corners.



A (350, 450) B (1450, 650)

C (1450, 2050) D (350, 1850)

E (800, 150) F (1900, 350)

G (1900, 1750)

Front: A-B-C-D

Side: B-F-G-C | Top: A-E-F-B

Illustrated checkpoint—not a Photoshop screenshot.

WHY

A single corner mapping transforms the whole panel coherently and preserves the flat artwork inside the Smart Object.

CHECK

The top and bottom edges slope together, and all four corners meet the guide vertices.

FIX

Dragging a side handle scales or skews instead of mapping the correct corner. Re-enter Distort and move the four corner handles, not the middle handles.

Tool reference: S4, S12. Recipe values are lesson starting points.

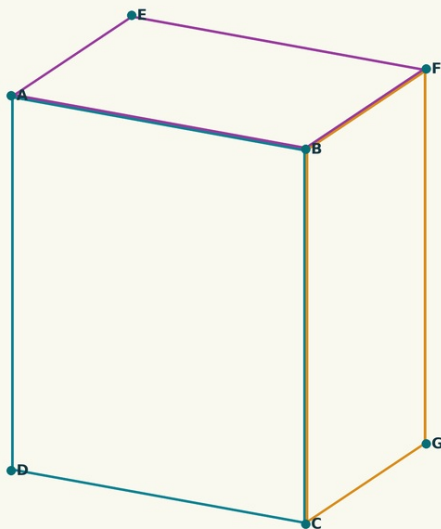
Add the side and top panels

SELECT FIRST Two small panel documents, then the MOCKUP document.

1. Build a side panel in a new **620 × 1800 px** RGB document. Fill navy **#153842**. Add cream live text **DINO / LOOPS** in its upper third, four small coloured rectangles in the middle, and **DESIGN CONCEPT / NOT FOR SALE** near the bottom. Save a layered PSD and export a PNG.
2. Build a top panel in a new **1100 × 420 px** document. Fill **#F5C851** and centre navy **DINO LOOPS** text. Save/export it. Approved shortcut: the pack supplies `side_panel_support.png` and `top_panel_support.png`.
3. In MOCKUP, Place Embedded your side PNG. Use Free Transform > Distort to map its source corners **top-left B(1450,650)**, **top-right F(1900,350)**, **bottom-right G(1900,1750)**, **bottom-left C(1450,2050)**.
4. Place the top PNG. Map its source **top-left A(350,450)**, **top-right E(800,150)**, **bottom-right F(1900,350)**, **bottom-left B(1450,650)**. Text follows that mapping; rotate the flat top artwork first if you prefer another reading direction.
5. Name the layers **Side panel** and **Top panel**. Check that B and F are shared exactly. Leave a tiny overlap behind the front rather than a bright background seam.

Shared corners make the mockup believable

COORDINATE DIAGRAM | Front, side and top meet at exactly the same B and F corners.



A (350, 450) B (1450, 650)

C (1450, 2050) D (350, 1850)

E (800, 150) F (1900, 350)

G (1900, 1750)

Front: A-B-C-D

Side: B-F-G-C | Top: A-E-F-B

Illustrated checkpoint—not a Photoshop screenshot.

WHY

Shared vertices make three separate images read as one solid object. The side design supports the brand without inventing mandatory packaging data.

CHECK

Front/side/top edges meet, and no white triangular gaps appear at the common corners.

FIX

A twisted panel usually has two corners swapped. Undo and map the four source corners in the stated order; do not drag through an opposite corner.

Tool reference: S4. Recipe values are lesson starting points.

40

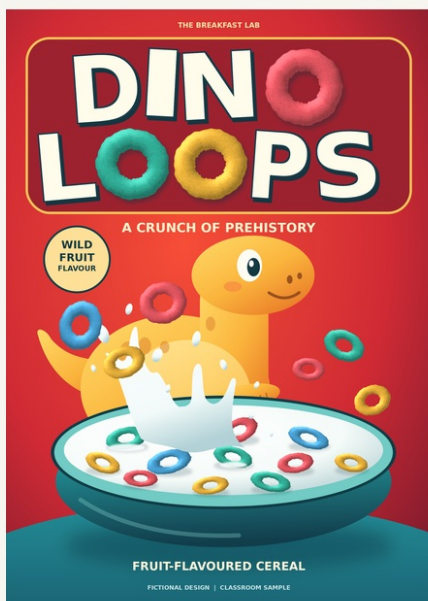
Finish and export the optional mockup

SELECT FIRST MOCKUP; create a new layer below all three panels.

1. Name it **Box shadow**. Draw a broad ellipse beneath the box, approximately **x260, y1860, w1700, h250**. Fill with a dark neutral blue-grey, deselect, and convert it to a Smart Object.
2. Apply **Filter > Blur > Gaussian Blur**, Radius about **60 px**. Lower opacity to **25-30%**. Keep the shadow behind the panels.
3. Hide TRACE mockup. Inspect every shared edge at 100%. If a seam remains, slightly overlap the rear panel underneath the front instead of painting over the front artwork.
4. Save **Surname_DinoLoops MOCKUP_FINAL.psd**. Use File > Export > Export As, PNG, **2200 x 2200 px**, Convert to sRGB where available. Reopen the PNG to verify it.
5. Submit the mockup as an additional presentation image, not a replacement for the flat front or construction evidence. State which side/top assets you built or used.

A flat cover becomes a perspective presentation

OPTIONAL EXTENSION | Three distorted 2D panels, not a 3D model or a print dieline.



Illustrated checkpoint—not a Photoshop screenshot.

WHY

The final shadow places the box in a scene. Verification ensures the submitted preview matches the intended construction.

CHECK

The flat front and optional box are both available. No trace lines, missing corners or mismatched panel edges remain.

FIX

This orthographic-style mockup is intentionally simplified. It does not prove print fit, fold accuracy, material thickness or a physically rendered lighting setup.

Tool reference: S5, S9. Recipe values are lesson starting points.

In-bowl cereal positions

Centre coordinates; visible width/height before rotation.

ID	Colour	Centre x	Centre y	Visible W	Visible H	Angle°
B01	teal	510	1810	180	92	-12
B02	gold	740	1750	155	83	14
B03	coral	985	1778	170	98	-24
B04	blue	1280	1810	180	85	18
B05	gold	410	1915	153	81	20
B06	blue	690	1910	194	98	-14
B07	teal	960	1890	170	85	15
B08	coral	1225	1915	155	84	-8
B09	gold	1460	1915	144	75	11
B10	coral	570	1980	147	70	3
B11	gold	865	2010	158	74	-8
B12	teal	1120	1995	175	81	12

Visible size versus source size

The coloured ring is about 600 px across in the 800 px construction document. A Smart Object may or may not retain transparent border space, depending on how it was created. If the outer transform box is 800 px across, use target visible size × 800/600 for its box. If it is cropped to the ring, use the visible target directly. Compare against the trace rather than entering a percentage blindly.

Place the cereal on the milk plane

ILLUSTRATED CHECKPOINT | Compare structure, not identical filter pixels.



- 1 Squash the rings vertically, then rotate in the image plane.
- 2 Vary position, size and colour without a perfect grid.
- 3 Do not claim these transforms rotate a true 3D object.

PSD geometry: 1800 x 2520 px | Stage 18

Illustrated checkpoint—not a Photoshop screenshot. Compare structure, not identical filter pixels.

Flying rings and droplets

Centres are in the 1800 × 2520 front document.

ID	Colour	Centre x	Centre y	Visible W	Visible H	Angle°
F01	blue	315	1335	180	210	20
F02	gold	500	1490	185	130	-22
F03	coral	665	1240	205	177	-12
F04	teal	1430	1420	180	125	25
F05	gold	1550	1650	160	126	-20
F06	coral	1280	1520	140	95	5

Droplets — full dimensions, not radii

ID	Centre x	Centre y	Full W	Full H	Angle°
01	410	1370	48	82	-23
02	520	1265	28	48	16
03	640	1460	40	60	25
04	805	1390	34	66	12
05	920	1500	28	46	-20
06	1040	1710	28	40	30
07	685	1600	20	36	10
08	370	1515	20	32	-20
09	1060	1585	20	32	25
10	1120	1790	18	26	-10

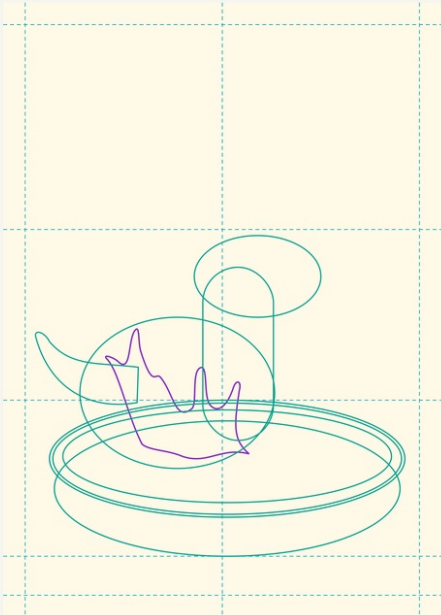
Lettering and the visual blueprint

Letter boxes use upper-left positions; adjust for your installed font.

Letter	Left x	Top y	Visible W	Visible H	Angle°
D	295	190	260	280	-4
I	600	170	115	280	3
N	755	180	285	280	-3
L	150	520	220	280	-5
P	1050	520	220	280	4
S	1320	515	240	280	-4

Layout map: numbers describe positions, not a grading target

DIAGRAM | Coordinates start at the upper-left corner of the 1800 x 2520 canvas.



- 1 Safe guides: x = 90 and 1710.
- 2 Wordmark zone: y = 120 to 860.
- 3 Mascot zone: y = 955 to 1910.
- 4 Bowl rim: x 190, y 1630; 1460 x 480.
- 5 Footer stays above y = 2430.

Illustrated checkpoint—not a Photoshop screenshot. Compare structure, not identical filter pixels.

The wordmark backing spans x88–1712 and y122–859. The tagline is near y900; the dinosaur head begins at y955. These gaps are intentional. The lower footer stays above y2430.

Splash anchor map

Click-drag at curved anchors; the reference points alone do not determine the handle lengths.

Splash path: anchor placement and handle direction

TRACE GUIDE | Place broad anchors first; reshape curves with Direct Selection (A).

1

Pen tool: Shape mode, no stroke.

2

Click-drag to create a rounded crest.

3

Alt/Option adjusts one handle.

4

Close the path at anchor 1.

5

Hide the trace guide before judging.

Illustrated checkpoint—not a Photoshop screenshot. Compare structure, not identical filter pixels.

Anchor	x	y	Anchor	x	y
1	570	1810	7	775	1665
2	425	1460	8	805	1500
3	470	1470	9	850	1650
4	545	1340	10	945	1580
5	565	1430	11	970	1590
6	645	1535	12	1010	1850

Follow the 12 main anchors in order and close at Anchor 1. Use the Direct Selection arrow to adjust handles and keep the tips round. Editable source: [editable_source/splash_shape.svg](#). The support PNG is a shortcut only; the full build uses a student-drawn shape.

Layer order and box corners

Layer order creates the occlusion; shared vertices create the box.

The layer stack is your depth map

SCHEMATIC | Top rows render in front. The guide sits at the top only while tracing.

07 COPY + LABELS

06 WORDMARK: letters / cereal O / backing

05 FLYING CEREAL

04 MILK FRONT: droplets / splash / overlap

03 IN-BOWL CEREAL + contact shadows

02 BOWL: milk / rim / body / ground shadow

01 MASCOT: face / arm / head / neck / body / tail

00 BACKGROUND: tabletop / radial background

90 LOOP MASTERS (hidden)

99 TRACE GUIDE (hidden, at top while tracing)

Illustrated checkpoint—not a Photoshop screenshot. Compare structure, not identical filter pixels.

Vertex	x	y
A	350	450
B	1450	650
C	1450	2050
D	350	1850
E	800	150
F	1900	350
G	1900	1750

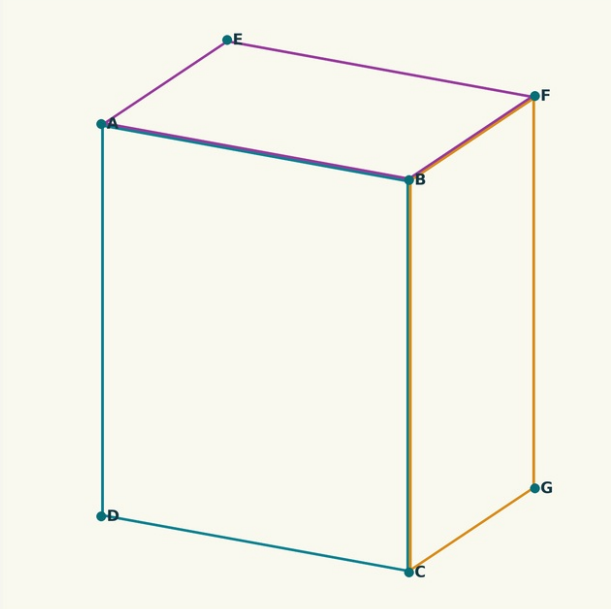
Front: A-B-C-D. Side: B-F-G-C. Top: A-E-F-B. Each sequence maps source top-left, top-right, bottom-right, bottom-left. See the next page for the labelled diagram.

Three flat panels, one presentation

The mockup is a 2D distortion exercise, not a mesh or a production dieline.

Shared corners make the mockup believable

COORDINATE DIAGRAM | Front, side and top meet at exactly the same B and F corners.



A (350, 450) B (1450, 650)

C (1450, 2050) D (350, 1850)

E (800, 150) F (1900, 350)

G (1900, 1750)

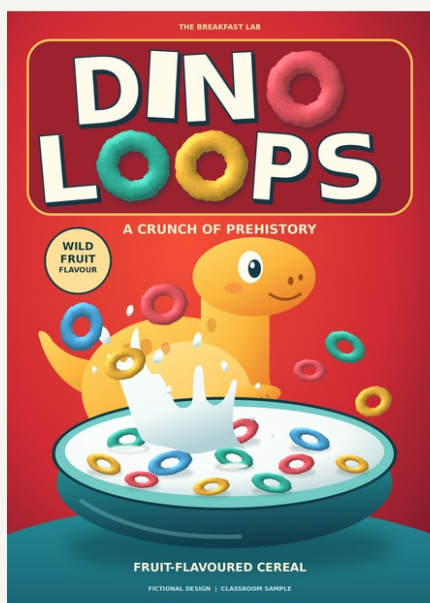
Front: A-B-C-D

Side: B-F-G-C | Top: A-E-F-B

Illustrated checkpoint—not a Photoshop screenshot. Compare structure, not identical filter pixels.

A flat cover becomes a perspective presentation

OPTIONAL EXTENSION | Three distorted 2D panels, not a 3D model or a print dieline.



Illustrated checkpoint—not a Photoshop screenshot. Compare structure, not identical filter pixels.

Find the cause 1 / 2

Change the smallest relevant part of the construction.

There is no old 3D menu or Donut command.

Follow Steps 10–16 instead. This lesson uses a transparent ring, editable styles and Smart Objects. Do not install a retired workflow merely to reproduce the old tutorial.

A shape disappears while I draw the next one.

Check Path Operations. Subtract Front Shape is used only to cut the ring hole; switch back to New Layer for the next component.

The ring has a white middle.

White is a painted area, not transparency. Repair the subtracted inner path or use the mask fallback in Step 10. Test on a red background and on milk.

Changing one cereal colour changes several pieces.

That is correct for linked instances of one flavour. For a different flavour, duplicate with New Smart Object Via Copy first, then edit the new embedded fill.

The master looks correct but the scene ring is tiny or huge.

Compare visible bounds, not the transparent source canvas. Step 17 explains the 800/600 conversion when applicable. Always type px when entering a pixel target.

The milk overlap hides almost every cereal ring.

The raster mask must start black. Select that mask, invert it if it was white, then paint small white strokes only over two lower cereal edges.

Find the cause 2 / 2

Change the smallest relevant part of the construction.

My brush paints white instead of revealing milk.

Undo. Click the black raster-mask thumbnail, not the milk/shape thumbnail or vector path. Set foreground white and repaint at low opacity.

Cereal seems pasted onto the red background.

Remove inappropriate Drop Shadows from flying pieces. Use layer overlap and modest squash. Keep contact shadows close to cereal resting in the bowl.

The dinosaur touches the tagline.

Use the final mascot positions in Step 22: the head begins at y955. The tagline is near y900. Adjust spacing while preserving the bowl overlap.

The wordmark does not read as DINO LOOPS.

Count the letters and cereal O pieces: D-I-N-O / L-O-O-P-S. Compare gaps at 10% zoom. Move related elements closer before adding decoration.

The optional box has a bright seam or twisted panel.

Map the four corners in the order shown in Steps 38–39. Match shared vertices. Put a slight panel overlap behind the front, rather than leaving a transparent gap.

My progress or notes disappeared.

Local browser storage can be disabled or cleared, particularly in private mode. Export notes each class; keep the HTML in the same location. The progress tool is a convenience, not a school submission system.

Product, process and explanation

Suggested classroom framework—not an official IB rubric.

Criterion	Success evidence	Where to look
Communication and hierarchy	Name, product and mascot are clear; text sizes and spacing establish a deliberate reading order.	A 10% view and the partner's five-second feedback.
Editable construction	Appropriate live type, shapes, Smart Objects, independent flavours and retained masks are visible.	Ring-master evidence and the final layered PSD.
Integration and finish	Cereal orientation, transparent holes, contact shadows, milk overlap and consistent light work together.	A detailed crop plus the layer stack; explain at least two relationships.
Revision and explanation	A specific change responds to feedback; the student explains why and declares support assets.	Before/after comparison and process reflection.

Suggested four-point interpretation

4: clear, controlled and independently explained. **3:** complete, mostly consistent and soundly explained. **2:** partial success with unresolved issues. **1:** limited demonstration requiring substantial support. Record missing evidence as “not yet assessed.” Four criteria can be recorded out of 16, or adapted to the course approach.

Submit the layered FRONT_FINAL.psd, FRONT.png, three process images, and a reflection. Include the optional mockup separately. A prepared support asset does not demonstrate the construction skills it bypasses.

Explain what the layers prove

Use the HTML notes export or write on this page.

Name / class:

How do two named layers or settings make the cereal feel dimensional?

What did your partner notice first? What changed after feedback, and why?

Which assets did you construct, which were supplied, and what did you adapt?

Pacing, support and verification

Preflight the difficult operations on one school computer.

Session	Focus	Evidence checkpoint
1	Setup, shapes, bowl, splash	Separate shape layers
2-3	Editable cereal master and flavours	Open contents and alter only one flavour
3-4	Distribution, shadows and masks	Explain two occlusion relationships
4-5	Mascot and wordmark	Original construction and live Type
6-8	Readability, revision and export	Feedback-linked before/after
Optional	Three-panel box presentation	Shared vertices and verified exports

Installed-version preflight

Test the ring subtraction, bevel settings, group-to-Smart-Object conversion, Liquify, New Smart Object Via Copy, black raster mask on the milk shape, installed bold font and PNG export. Confirm students can save layered PSD files locally. Adjust instructions for any different panel wording.

Verification scope

The HTML interactions, embedded downloads, image integrity and PDF layout are checked as files. The workflow has not been executed end-to-end inside Photoshop here. Documentation supports the tool choices; the technical illustrations show intended structure rather than guaranteed identical rendering.

Assess the skills actually demonstrated

Use the master as a gate before mass duplication. Supported students can demonstrate composition, type and masking while declaring provided construction. Stretch work may change the mascot, product story or side/top panel, but extra decoration alone is not stronger evidence.

References 1 / 2

Checked 17 September 2026. Sources document tools; lesson values and geometry are newly proposed.

S1 · Original inspiration — Alvaro Guzman, Envato Tuts+

[Open the source documentation](#)

CS4 Extended tutorial, first published September 2009; republished February 17, 2012. Concept reference only; this lesson is independently written.

S2 · Adobe — Layer style effects and options

[Open the source documentation](#)

Bevel & Emboss, shadows, gradients and shared lighting. Our numerical recipes are starting points, not Adobe-prescribed settings.

S3 · Adobe — Duplicate an embedded Smart Object

[Open the source documentation](#)

Distinguishes linked duplicates from New Smart Object Via Copy.

S4 · Adobe — Free Transform

[Open the source documentation](#)

Scaling, reference points, rotation and distortion; the aspect-ratio link controls proportional scaling.

S5 · Adobe — Apply Smart Filters

[Open the source documentation](#)

Editable filters applied to Smart Objects.

S6 · Adobe — Clipping masks

[Open the source documentation](#)

Restrict an upper layer to the transparency of the layer beneath it.

References 2 / 2

Checked 17 September 2026. Sources document tools; lesson values and geometry are newly proposed.

S7 · Adobe — Add layer masks

[Open the source documentation](#)

White reveals; black conceals. A mask changes visibility without deleting pixels.

S8 · Adobe — Liquify

[Open the source documentation](#)

Forward Warp and its brush controls.

S9 · Adobe — Export As

[Open the source documentation](#)

Export options, formats and dimensions.

S10 · Adobe — Create shapes

[Open the source documentation](#)

Shape tools and editable shape properties.

S11 · Adobe — Substance 3D Viewer status

[Open the source documentation](#)

The page warns that Viewer is no longer supported or available for installation as of October 16, 2025. This lesson does not require it.

S12 · Adobe — Create embedded Smart Objects

[Open the source documentation](#)

Embedding assets and preserving source content.

All supplied cereal, mascot, splash, bowl, diagram and mockup assets were newly constructed for this resource. They are technical illustrations/composites, not photographs or screenshots from Photoshop, and were not rendered by running this recipe inside Photoshop. Numerical values are reproducible starting points; fonts and layer-style output can vary. Original Tuts+ text and stock assets are not repackaged. No font files are included. The support files are provided for this classroom exercise; declare their use rather than presenting them as student-created construction.